MIL-STD-1411
6 August 1976

MILITARY STANDARD

INSPECTION AND MAINTENANCE

OF

COMPRESSED GAS CYLINDERS

FSC 8120

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MIL-STD-1411
6 August 1976

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE
Washington, DC 20301

Inspection and Maintenance of Compressed Gas Cylinders

MIL-STD-1411

1. This Military Standard is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

2. Recommended corrections, additions, or deletions should be addressed to: Commander, USA Mobility Equipment Research and Development Command, ATTN: DRXFB-DS, Fort Belvoir, VA 22060.

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FORWORD

This bookform Military Standard presents definitions, general requirements and detailed procedures for the inspection, maintenance and recharging of Government-owned cylinders for the procurement of compressed gases. The Standard presents guidelines which recognize and define precise variations from plant to plant. It is a standard for procurement specifications which have presented confusing methods for cylinder inspection and maintenance. It is intended to resolve problems encountered by compressed gas suppliers and Government procurement and inspection activities in agreeing on acceptable procedures for servicing compressed gas containers.

This standard deals with receiving and serviceability inspection and sets standards for acceptance and rejection of gas cylinders. It establishes procedures for internal and external maintenance. It classifies and details the recharging of cylinders and the purging and evacuating of air and residual gas from previous charging. Details are presented as guidelines for cylinder handling.

For cylinders declared to be unfit for further use as pressure vessels instructions are given for condemnation and disposal.

The intention of this document is to provide Government agencies and the compressed gas industry supporting the Government with a standard of procedure for cylinder inspection and maintenance that is compatible with Government requirements as well as with standard industrial practice.

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TABLE I. Inspection and maintenance procedure.

CYLINDER GAS SERVICE		Acetylene	Fuel gas mix	Air - human respiration	Air - indust	Argon - inert	Butane - propane	Carbon dioxide	Carbon monoxide	Chlorine	Fluoro - carbons	Helium - inert	Hydrogen	Inert nitrogen O.F.	Inert nitrogen OT	Oxygen ABO	Oxygen Tech.	Oxygen medical	Methyl bromide	Sulfur hexafluoride	Ammonia anhydrous	
Detailed Specifications	5.0																					5.0
Receiving inspection Complete Except as Listed	5.1	5.1.1.6 5.1.1.7 5.1.6	5.1.1.5	5.1.1.6 5.1.1.7	5.1.1.6 5.1.1.7	5.1.1.6 5.1.1.7	5.1.1.5	5.1.1.7	5.1.1.6 5.1.1.7	5.1.1.5	5.1.1.5	5.1.1.6 5.1.1.7	5.1.1.6 5.1.1.7	5.1.1.6 5.1.1.7	5.1.1.6 5.1.1.7	5.1.1.6 5.1.1.7	5.1.1.6 5.1.1.7	5.1.1.6 5.1.1.7	5.1.1.5	5.1.1.7	5.1.1.5	5.1
Serviceability inspection	5.2	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.2
Residual gas and moisture	5.2.1	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.2.1
External inspection	5.2.2	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.2.2
Paint inspection	5.2.2.1	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.2.2.1
Valve protection cap insp.	5.2.2.2	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.2.2.2
Valves and safety devices	5.2.3	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.2.3
Safety devices	5.2.3.1	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.2.3.1
Inspection of flanges	5.2.4	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.2.4
Inspection of foot rings	5.2.5	X	X				X			X	X								X		X	5.2.5
Periodic test inspection	5.2.6	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.2.6
Cyls. requiring hydro test	5.2.6.1			X	X	X		X	X	X		X	X	X	X	X	X	X		X		5.2.6.1
External visual insp.	5.2.6.2		X				X				X								X		X	5.2.6.2
Acetylene cylinder insp.	5.2.6.3	X																				5.2.6.3
General internal insp.	5.2.7		X	X	X	X		X	X	X		X	X	X	X	X	X	X		X		5.2.7
Hammer test	5.2.7.1		X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.2.7.1
Other test	5.2.7.2			X	X	X		X				X	X	X	X	X	X	X		X		5.2.7.2
Sulf. Hex F. cyl. intern. insp.	5.2.8																			X		5.2.8
Chlorine cyl. intern. insp.	5.2.9									X												5.2.9
Rejection and condemnation	5.2.10	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.2.10
Recording required services	5.2.11	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.2.11
Cylinder maintenance	5.3	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.3
Periodic testing	5.3.1	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.3.1
Hydrostatic test	5.3.1.1			X	X	X		X	X			X	X	X	X	X	X	X		X		5.3.1.1
External visual insp.	5.3.1.2		X				X				X								X		X	5.3.1.2
Acetylene cyl. requalifications	5.3.1.3	X																				5.3.1.3
General cyl. maintenance	5.3.2			X	X	X		X	X			X	X	X	X	X	X	X				5.3.2
Droplight testing	5.3.2.1		X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.3.2.1
Cyl. structural maint.	5.3.2.2		X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.3.2.2
Intern. cyl. surface cleaning	5.3.2.3		X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.3.2.3
Intern. cyl. drying	5.3.2.4		X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.3.2.4
Valves and safety devices	5.3.2.5	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.3.2.5
Acetylene cyl. gen. maint.	5.3.3	X																				5.3.3
Chlorine cyl. maintenance	5.3.4									X												5.3.4
Special handling	5.3.5									X	X			X		X				X		5.3.5

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TABLE I. Inspection and maintenance procedure. - Continued

CYLINDER GAS SERVICE		Acetylene	Fuel gas mix	Air - breathing respiration	Air - instrument	Argon - inert	Butane - propane	Carbon dioxide	Carbon monoxide	Chlorine	Fluoro - carbons	Helium - inert	Hydrogen	Inert nitrogen O.F.	Inert nitrogen O.T.	Oxygen ABO	Oxygen Tech.	Oxygen medical	Methyl bromide	Sulfur hexafluoride	Ammonia anhydrous	
Extern cyl. surface maint	6.3.6	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.3.6
Cyl valve protection caps	5.3.6.1	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.3.6.1
Paint, decal, rust removal	5.3.6.2	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.3.6.2
Metal surface pretreatment	5.3.6.3	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.3.6.3
Prime coating	5.3.6.4	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.3.6.4
Finish coating	6.3.6.5	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.3.6.5
Touch-up painting	6.3.6.6	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.3.6.6
Cylinder charging	6.4	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.4
Permanent gases	6.4.1			X	X	X			X			X	X	X	X	X	X	X				5.4.1
Liquified gases	5.4.2		X				X	X		X	X								X	X	X	5.4.2
Ammonia gases	6.4.2.1																					5.4.2.1
Chlorine gases	5.4.2.2									X												5.4.2.2
Fluoro-carbon gases	5.4.2.3										X											5.4.2.3
Liquified petroleum gases	6.4.2.4						X															5.4.2.4
Fuel gas mixtures	6.4.2.5		X																			5.4.2.5
Carbon dioxide gases	6.4.2.6							X														5.4.2.6
Sulfur hexafluoride gases	6.4.2.7																			X		5.4.2.7
Acetylene gases	5.4.3	X																				5.4.3
Leak testing	5.4.4	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	5.4.4
Leak testing ABO	5.4.4.1															X						5.4.4.1

NOTE.

Maintenance requirements for a specific cylinder shall be established at Receiving or Serviceability inspection or in the contract.

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1. SCOPE

1.1 Coverage. This standard defines the requirements and procedures incident to inspection, maintenance, and charging of Government owned cylinders. This standard is applicable to cylinders forwarded to a gas supplier to assure that the cylinders are serviced to meet safety standards and to assure that the quality of the gas supplied is not degraded by a Government container. This standard is also applicable to cylinders forwarded for cylinder reconditioning, repair, and rebuild to assure a level of renewal to meet the needs of the Government and Industry in gas handling. This standard is also to be a guide when cylinders are sorted, graded, and classified for storage, salvage, or disposal in depot facilities.

1.1.1 Procedures. Procedures shall be as follows:

(a) Receiving inspection.
(b) Serviceability inspection.
(c) Cylinder and valve maintenance and repair.
(d) Cylinder purging and recharging.

2. REFERENCED DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this standard to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

TT-C-490	- Cleaning Methods and Pretreatment of Ferrous Surfaces for Organic Coatings.
TT-E-489	- Enamel, Alkyd, Gloss (for Exterior and Interior Surfaces).
TT-L-32	- Lacquer, Cellulose Nitrate, Gloss, For Aircraft Use.

MILITARY

MIL-V-2	- Valves, Cylinder, Gas (for Compressed or Liquified Gases) General Specification for.
MIL-T-704	- Treatment and Painting of Materiel.

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MIL-C-8514	- Coating Compound, Metal Pretreatment Resin-Acid.
MIL-P-15328	- Primer (Wash), Pretreatment, Blue (Formula No. 117-B for Metals).
MIL-C-17376	- Caps and Flanges, Compressed-Gas Cylinder, General Specification for.
MIL-L-25567	- Leak Detection Compound, Oxygen Systems.
MIL-O-27210	- Oxygen, Aviator's Breathing, Liquid and Gas.
MIL-T-27730	- Tape, Antisieze, Polytetrafluroethylene, with Dispenser.
MIL-C-52752	- Cylinders, Compressed Gas, Packaging of.
MIL-T-81533	- 1, 1, 1 Trichloroethane (Methyl Chloroform) Inhibited, Vapor Degreasing.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED. STD. No. 595	- Colors.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-101	- Color Code for Pipelines and for Compressed Gas Cylinders
MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage.

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this standard to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

AMERICAN NATIONAL STANDARDS INSTITUTE, INC. (ANSI)

B57.1 - Compressed Gas Cylinder Valve Outlet and Inlet Connections.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American National Standards Institute, Inc., 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018.)

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AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

STANDARDS:

D 2029 - Water Vapor Content of Electrical Insulating Gases by Measurement of Dew-Point.
D 2200 - Pictoral Surface Preparation Standards for Painting Steel Surfaces - Standard B-Sa-1.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

COMPRESSED GAS ASSOCIATION, INC. (CGA)

C-1 Methods for Hydrostatic Testing of Compressed Gas Cylinders.
C-5 Cylinder Service Life Seamless, High Pressure Cylinder Specification.
C-6 Standards for Visual Inspection of Compressed Gas Cylinders.
S-1.1 Safety Relief Device Standards.
C-4.1 Equipment Cleaned for Oxygen Service.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Compressed Gas Association, Inc., 500 Fifth Avenue, New York, NY 10036.)

DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION (DOT)

49 CFR 171-190 - Code of Federal Regulations, Title 49.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Department of Transportation, Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

3. DEFINITIONS

3.1 Department of Transportation (DOT). DOT is the Federal agency responsible for the requirements of shipping hazardous materials including compressed and liquified gases. In this capacity, DOT prepares Title 49 of the Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) which covers most of the detailed shipping requirements for compressed gases. Additional regulations for air and sea shipments are included in Titles 14 and 46, respectively. Government cylinders are considered subject to the CFR by this standard, however, the CFR provides special allowance

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for emergency military shipments. Special privilege in no way relieves the Military of certifying the safety of these shipments. The responsibility for the Title 49 of the Code of Federal Regulations, formerly maintained by the Interstate Commerce Commission, has been transferred to the Office of Hazardous Materials of the Department of Transportation. Therefore, all ICC prefixes for cylinder specifications remain acceptable and all new cylinders will be marked with DOT prefixes (see 5.1.1.2). Prefix, specification, and service pressure (ICC 3AA 2015 or DOT 3AA 2015) will be marked in accordance with the current issue of the Code of Federal Regulations, Title 49, as applicable.

3.2 Compressed Gas Association (CGA). The CGA is an industry association which is actively involved in preparing safety standards for the handling and shipping of compressed gases. Important CGA Pamphlets which are referenced in the CFR, Title 49 include C-1, Methods for Hydrostatic Testing of Compressed Gas Cylinders and C-6, Standards for Visual Inspection of Compressed Gas Cylinders. These documents are also referenced in this standard. Other CGA documents are referenced as applicable.

3.3 Bureau of Explosives. The Bureau of Explosives is an agency of the Association of American Railroads, which has been delegated certain responsibilities in the CFR, Title 49. Important assignments for the compressed gas industry are the approval of cylinder repair, rebuild, remanufacture, and testing facilities, the approval of hydrostatic test facilities for cylinder testing, the approval of safety device designs for pressure vessels, and the control of cylinder identification markings.

3.4 Compressed gases. Compressed gases are defined as elements or compounds and mixtures of elements or compounds which will be contained in the gaseous state with a gage pressure of at least 25 psig at 70° F or 119 psig at 130° F. If the gas is flammable, the lower pressure limit is 25 psig at 100° F.

3.4.1 Permanent and liquified gases. A permanent gas is defined as a compressed gas that will not liquify between 25 psig and 2500 psig, at 70° F. These gases have boiling points below -150° F. Examples are oxygen, nitrogen, and hydrogen. A liquified gas is defined as an element

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or compound that exists as a liquid at 70° F under pressure ranging from 25 psig to 2500 psig. Examples are chlorine, propane, and fluorocarbon refrigerants.

3.4.1.1 Cryogenic fluid. A cryogenic fluid is defined as a permanent gas which has been cooled below its boiling point (below -150° F) and liquified. Evaporation of the integral fluid and insulated containers maintain the stability of cryogenic fluids in storage. Examples are liquid oxygen, nitrogen, and argon.

3.4.2 Liquified petroleum gas (LPG). LP-gas is a term defining certain combinations of hydrocarbon gases such as butane, propane, isobutane, and butane-propane as mixtures. These compounds, under their own contained vapor pressure, will maintain a liquid state at the temperature of 70° F. LP-gases are compounds with molecules containing three or four carbon chains and are the fraction of petroleum separation falling between the natural gases and the gasolines. Natural gas is made up of methane and ethane, one and two carbon chain molecules, which have high pressure properties. Longer chain molecules including the N-pentanes are removed with the gasolines. LP-gases have specific gravities ranging from .300 to .630, with better than 95 percent falling between .508 and .584. Propane has a boiling point of -44° F. Liquified propane in a container at 70° F will maintain a pressure head of approximately 100 psig.

3.4.3 Dissolved gas. A dissolved gas is defined as a gas that will be absorbed or will be dissolved in a liquid medium. Acetylene gas dissolved in acetone is a system that will dissolve as much as 400 volumes of acetylene gas in one volume of acetone liquid under 250 psig of gas pressure at 70° F.

3.4.4 Medical gases. Gases used by the Government medical services for medical purposes are oxygen, nitrous oxide, and ethylene oxide-dichlorodifluoromethane mixture (sterilant). Whenever appropriate in this standard the term "medical gas" shall alert the contractor to certain necessary precautions particularly concerning materials employed in oxygen valves.

3.5 Compressed gas cylinders. Compressed gas cylinders are closely regulated by specification for construction and test in the Code of Federal Regulations, Title 49, Part 178, Subpart C. The Government uses

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seamless cylinders in all high pressure applications (above 900 psig service pressures) and in many low pressure applications such as in ammonia and chlorine service. Seamless cylinders may be fabricated by billet piercing and plate drawing or by spinning processes in accordance with DOT 3A and 3AA specifications. The Government generally uses DOT series 4 and series 8 cylinders in low pressure applications (not to exceed 500 psi). They are fabricated by welding or brazing shells drawn from plate stock for specified maximum service pressures.

3.5.1 Drawn seamless cylinders. Drawn seamless cylinders are made by heating a billet of steel and piercing it with a mandrel. The cylinder is progressively drawn by hydraulic press to the desired shell size. Drawn seamless cylinders are also made from pre-cut steel disks and drawn in hydraulic presses to the desired size and shape. The wall thickness is controlled in accordance with DOT 3A or 3AA specification for a given service pressure application. The shell is again heated and spun as a swinging arbor shapes the shoulder and neck for closure of the upper end. The neck is drilled and tapped and fitted with a valve as applicable for intended use. Low pressure seamless cylinders may have a foot ring welded directly to the bottom of the pressure bearing portion of the cylinder for protection against wear and for stability. High pressure cylinders cannot be welded or heated after fabrication at any time, except by the manufacturer of similar cylinders. Neck rings are pressed and peened in place and are maintained without the use of heat.

3.5.2 Spun cylinders. Spun cylinders are fabricated from seamless tube stock of a diameter and wall thickness of the specified cylinder. A predetermined length is placed in a lathe and spun, and both ends are closed by heating and shaping. In shaping, the side wall is flowed inward until all the slag and edge stock are brought to the center of the cylinder top and bottom. The top shoulder is shaped and handled much like a drawn cylinder. It is drilled and tapped for proper valve inlet threads. The bottom is bumped back for standing stability and the center is broached free of slag and oxides. In a controlled atmosphere, the metal is again flowed inward and closure is completed by inert welding. If a failure in closure occurs, the bottom which is heavier than the side walls due to inward flow of steel, will be drilled, tapped, and plugged to effect an acceptable closure in accordance with the Code of Federal Regulations. Spun cylinders are in general use in the Government system in DOT 3A and DOT 3AA applications, and have provided years of dependable service.

3.5.3 Welded and brazed cylinders. Welded and brazed cylinders are fabricated in accordance with DOT series 39, 4, and 8 specifications.

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These cylinders are intended for use in low pressure applications in service pressures up to a maximum of 500 psi. Specifications DOT 4BA, DOT 4BW, DOT 4E, and DOT 4B fall in this grouping. According to specification, a longitudinal seam is allowed or not allowed. In the latter case, two shells are drawn into cups and a single circumferential welded or brazed seam closes their joining edges. Maintenance of DOT series 4 cylinders by welding is permitted by certified repair and rebuild shops throughout their useful life.

3.5.4 Acetylene cylinders. Acetylene cylinders are fabricated in accordance with Specification DOT 8, or 8AL. They are low pressure cylinders limited in service pressure to 250 psi and equipped with safety devices that will melt at 212° F to relieve internal pressure in case of excessive heat or fire. Acetylene is a flammable gas that will detonate on impact. Because of this property, the compressed acetylene gas must be finely divided and cushioned if safe handling is to be achieved. An efficient way to meet this requirement is to dissolve acetylene gas in a liquid. Acetone is the solvent of choice. For increased safety and to guard against separation of a volume of acetylene, the steel cylinder is filled with a porous inert material. Early cylinders used asbestos felt, later processes used asbestos fibers, charcoal, and Portland cement to produce a monolithic filler. Modern fillers are made from refracted calcium silicate and have up to a 92 percent porosity to accept the largest volumes of acetone in a monolithic or (one stone) filler. An acetylene cylinder charged with acetone, under 250 psi pressure, will absorb up to 400 times the volume of the liquid acetone in acetylene gas.

3.5.5 Disposable cylinders. Disposable cylinders are fabricated for a specific gas distribution. They are fabricated and used in accordance with Specification DOT 39. Disposable cylinders are low pressure containers and are tested at the vapor pressure of the gas of intended use at 130° F or at 180 psi, whichever is greater. Cylinders of each lot are pressure tested to destruction which cannot occur at less than 2 times the test pressure in any application. Disposable cylinders are fabricated for one trip use from the commodity supplier to utilization by the user. Federal law forbids transportation if refilled - penalty up to $10,000 fine and 10 years imprisonment (18USC. 831-835).

3.5.6 Wire wrapped cylinder. The wire wrapped cylinder will use up to three layers of steel wire over its outside surface to provide nonshatterability in high-pressure application. The wire wrapping

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must be removed for the cylinder to undergo hydrostatic testing. Wrapping is costly and very specialized. However, wire wrapping is a practical way to provide safe high-pressure reservoirs.

3.5.7 Composite and fiberglass containers. The composite is generally cylindrical in design with enough metal in the sidewalls and heads to withstand the longitudinal stress of internal pressure ratings. The hoop stress of the cylinder is shared with fiberglass wrappings closely adhereing to the exterior walls. High strength-to-density ratios are achieved by adding multiple layers of fiberglass filament at controlled tension and bonded into a composite unit with epoxy resin. The whole structure must be protected against moisture penetration to assure a stable design and extended life. The composite must undergo hydrostatic testing intact, because removal of the fiberglass reinforcement would destroy the strength designed into the vessel. Fiberglass containers are also manufactured with gas tight liners in which the liners are not depended upon to insure the integrity of the pressure vessel.

3.6 Cylinder service pressure and proof pressure. The service pressure for each cylinder is permanently marked on the cylinder immediately following the DOT specification (DOT 3AA 2015 or DOT 4BA 240). For the purpose of this document, high-pressure cylinders are those with a marked service pressure of 900 psig or greater; low-pressure cylinders are those with a marked service pressure less than 900 psig. At manufacture, each cylinder is tested at its proof pressure. The service pressure is the maximum pressure for a given cylinder in normal gas service. The proof pressure is the pressure (5/3 x service pressure) at which a cylinder is hydrostatically tested. Low pressure cylinders may be proof tested at two times the service pressure in accordance with the CFR 173.34, para (9) modified hydrostatic test method. Cylinders charged with permanent gases, working pressure will drop as the contents are released. Cylinders charged with liquified gas will hold a constant working pressure related to the temperature and the vapor pressure for the specific liquified gas as long as liquid remains in the cylinder.

3.7 Safety device. The safety device is a pressure sensitive or a temperature sensitive mechanism that will protect the container against rupture by controlled release of the compressed gas. Release may be due to pressure rupture of a frangible disk or by pressure activating a spring-loaded relief valve. Release in the case of a fusible metal plug will be due to heat in the immediate environment greater than the melting point of the base metal (165° F or 212° F). A combination

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device made up of a disk backed with fusible metal is designed to be used where the container contents will not be released unless the necessary heat to activate the fusible metal and pressure in the burst range of the disk exist at the same time. This provides better control over inadvertant loss of contents. A combination safety device is never used on containers approved for charging 10 percent above marked service pressure. Approved safety devices and applications are detailed in the Compressed Gas Association's Pamphlet S-1.1, Safety Relief Standards. MIL-V-2 outlines safety devices in Government applications as follows:

S-1 Frangible disk
S-2 Fusible plug 165° F nominal
S-3 Fusible plug 212° F nominal
S-4 Comb frangible disk-fusible plug 165° F
S-5 Comb frangible disk-fusible plug 212° F
S-6 Cancelled
S-7 Safety relief valve (spring loaded)

3.8 Tare weight "TW". Tare weight is used to determine the quantity of gas commodity required to charge a cylinder by weight. The tare weight of a compressed gas cylinder includes the empty cylinder with its valve, but does not include the valve protection cap. Tare weight is generally marked in pounds and tenths of pounds, following the letters "TW", for liquified gas applications. Cylinders in acetylene service require the tare weight to be permanently marked on the cylinder, flange or cylinder collar and includes the acetone and filler material. Tare weight markings on acetylene cylinders are generally indicated by a whole number for pounds and a whole number in 4 ounce increments (0, 4, 8, 12). Acetylene cylinders 10 cubic feet or less are marked with a whole number for pounds and the exact whole number for ounces.

3.9 Water capacity. Water capacity defines the internal volume of a cylinder. Water capacity is an optional marking on Government-owned cylinders. High pressure cylinders for permanent gases (3A and 3AA) are generally made to a standard diaplacement in cubic inches and at given conditions will contain a specific volume of gas. Charging is limited by the service pressure permanently marked on the cylinder. To determine the contents of a cylinder of standard nominal capacity, determine the pressure and temperature of the gas and find the corresponding capacity in cubic feet at standard conditions from an approved pressure/temperature/capacity chart. A standard 9 inch x 51 inch cylinder with a water capacity of 2640 cubic inches will contain 200 cubic feet of oxygen compressed to 2015 psi at 70° F. Water capacity for low pressure liquified gases (4BA, 4BW and 4E cylinders) is the weight of water required to completely fill the

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cylinder. This weight is used to calculate the filling density for a specific gas from limits specified in the Code of Federal Regulations.

3.10 Filling density. The term "filling density" shall designate the percent ratio of the weight of gas in a container to the weight of water (water capacity) the container will hold at 60° F. Percent filling density for a specific liquified gas shall be in accordance with the Code of Federal Regulations, Title 49. To determine the actual filling density (amount of gas to safely fill a specific cylinder), the water capacity of the cylinder is multiplied by the decimal equivalent of the percent filling density for the gas of intended use. This filling density correctly applied will protect a cylinder against the excessive pressures of thermal expansion up to 130° F either from the increased pressure from the gaseous state or from the fluid expansion of the liquid state, as applicable. An interesting example is carbon dioxide with a filling density of 68 percent. Below 87.8° F carbon dioxide will liquify, but above 87.8° F a liquid state cannot exist regardless of pressure. 87.8° F is the critical temperature for carbon dioxide. The filling density has been carefully selected for each liquified gas to take into account potential safety hazards.

3.11 Nonshatterability. Nonshatterability is the property of the metal in a cylinder to remain in one piece rather than to fragment when a cylinder bursts from excessive pressure or when pierced by a high velocity projectile. Nonshatterable cylinders will be identified by one of the following markings stamped into the metal of the cylinder: NONSHATTERABLE, NONSHAT, SHATTERPROOF; DOT (ICC) 3AA cylinders 8 inches or larger in diameter are accepted as nonshatterable, and all cylinders manufactured after 6-44 stamped 51-C-31 (INT) or 51-C-31 are accepted as nonshatterable. Cylinders identified SPS 844 (INT), SPS 1022 (INT), 51-C-26 (INT), 51-C-41 (INT), 51-C-26, and 51-C-27 shall be considered nonshatterable. Other cylinders have been determined through testing procedures to be nonshatterable and are so marked (see 5.1.1.5).

3.11.1 Gunfire testing. Historically, the Government agencies gunfire tested high-pressure cylinders to evaluate fragmentation properties as well as to evaluate the controlled release of compressed gas contained in the cylinder at the marked service pressure. General applications for 3AA cylinders are concerned with fragmentation, and specifications for 9-inch x 51-inch cylinders limit fragmentation to not more than two pieces as the internal pressure is released. Cylinders in accordance with MIL-C-7905, fire extinguisher and carbon dioxide specifications generally limit separation about projectile apertures to a maximum of

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3 inches from the hole centers. After extensive gunfire testing by both Government and industry, the property of fragment control (nonshatterability) has been related to variation in wall stress as defined in DOT 49CFR173.302. Dot specification 3AA limits the designed maximum wall stress to 73,000 psi. The cylinder industry, in independent investigations, have found, when wall stress designs are ranged between 50,000 psi and 60,000 psi, conservative nonshatterable properties are assured. Testing has verified that cylinders 8 inches and larger in diameter fabricated within the limits of DOT 3AA will pass gunfire fragmentation requirements and therefore, Government 3AA cylinders in excess of 8 inches in diameter have been marked "NONSHAT" by the manufacturer for a number of years. With the specification RR-C-901, Government cylinders under 8 inches in diameter fabricated in accordance with DOT 3AA cylinder specifications with a maximum wall stress under 55,000 psi are considered to be nonshatterable, and will offer controlled release of the marked service pressure. These cylinders will be permanently marked "NONSHAT".

3.12 Color code. The Government has developed its own system of color coding its pipeline and compressed gas cylinders (see MIL-STD-101). These color identification codes are mandatory along with the name of the gas, as applicable, stenciled longitudinally and opposite on the exterior surfaces of a Government-owned cylinder. When vendor-owned cylinders are used, MIL-STD-101 is not mandatory, except for medical gas cylinders which are always color coded in accordance with MIL-STD-101.

3.13. Periodic test status. Cylinders are periodically tested by hydrostatic test procedures, or subjected to an external visual examination. Cylinders may be refilled for a period of 5 years before retesting or complete examination is required. Acetylene cylinders are an exception to this rule, as they will be completely inspected prior to refilling after 20 years. The Code of Federal Regulations has approved the use of a 10 year test period for high pressure cylinders by special testing and these cylinders are marked with a star following the test date. The Government is presently using the 5 year retest period but is considering the application of 10 year requirements. The CFR also makes provision for 5 year complete external visual inspection of cylinders used in exclusive noncorrosive liquified gas service. The Government permits external visual examination of low pressure cylinder services for liquified petroleum gases, and some fluorocarbon gas cylinders. These cylinders are permanently marked with the letter "E" after the date of the inspection. Certain low pressure cylinders may be retested after 12 years, then every 7 years by the modified hydrostatic test method with the test

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date followed by the symbol "S". For acetylene cylinders, a 20 year requalification and internal inspection for either nonmonolithic or monolithic filler material is required (see 5.3.1.3 and 5.3.3).

3.14 Hydrostatic testing. The hydrostatic pressure tests are performed on cylinders every 5 years for most services to determine fitness for further use. During the hydrostatic test, a cylinder is stressed with water pressure to a value determined by the cylinder specification and the marked service pressure. The total expansion of the cylinder and the value of permanent expansion after the pressure is released are recorded. The permanent expansion is subtracted from the total expansion to calculate the elastic expansion. An acceptable cylinder will have a permanent expansion less than 10 percent of its total expansion. A proper hydrostatic test is the basis for a valid estimate of the average wall thickness of the cylinder and therefore a measure of the erosion of the walls in corrosion processes. Details for hydrostatic test procedures are presented in the CGA Pamphlet C-1, Methods for Hydrostatic Testing of Compressed Gas Cylinders.

3.14.1 Calibrated cylinder. The calibrated cylinder is a cylinder that has been prestressed until the expansion pattern becomes reproducible up to a given predetermined pressure. A cylinder with known expansion characteristics for given pressures is used as a standard to calibrate a hydrostatic test set-up. A calibrated cylinder is an instrument of calibration and must be handled with care to guard against dents, overpressurizing, and corrosion.

3.14.2 Registered facility. The Code of Federal Regulations requires that each hydrostatic test facility be registered with the Bureau of Explosives before it is placed in operation testing cylinders. This registration is a control on the installed equipment for safety and accuracy. Generally, any system can be registered if its repetitive tests compare with known values for a calibrated cylinder.

3.15 Certified hydrostatic test facility. The Bureau of Explosives has been authorized in the Code of Federal Regulations, Title 49, to inspect and certify approved hydrostatic test facilities upon request by the owner. The Bureau responds to the tester's request to have his facility and major personnel evaluated for reliability of equipment and capability of performance. The Government requires the certification of hydrostatic test facilities.

3.16 Authorized repair and rebuild facilities. CFR, Title 49, Para. 173.34 limits repair and rebuild activities very specifically. Repair

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commodity specification and will assure that the compressed gas can be safely handled by personnel. Procedures for cylinder handling shall be as listed in Table I and as detailed in Section 5. Procedures shall be in accordance with CFR, Title 49. When an established procedure, such as the Compressed Gas Association Pamphlet C-1 and C-6 is applicable, it will be referred to and shall be used in detail as a guideline for acceptable practice. A compressed gas or cylinder service contract will include an item description with the applicable gas specification. In addition, the level of cylinder reconditioning required will be specified. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or work order, maintenance will include valve maintenance, internal cylinder maintenance, hydrostatic testing, external cylinder maintenance, as required, and cylinder evacuation to a minimum of 3 inches of mercury as detailed in 5.3. When specified, a contractor shall be able to perform or supply authorized repair and rebuild functions (see 3.16) in order to qualify as an acceptable contractor of gas commodity or cylinder service, as applicable by this standard. Cylinder reclamation requiring heat treatment shall be limited to contractors who are presently manufacturing like cylinders in accordance with the applicable specification in the Code of Federal Regulations, Title 49.

4.1.1 Receiving inspection. Government-owned cylinders shall be inspected to assure conformance to the item description provided in the shipping document. Cylinders received by a contractor for reconditioning or recharging with a specific gas or received by a Government agency for grading and storage shall be inspected for proper legible, and accurate identifications, markings, dimensions, color coding and stenciling. Inspection shall assure the presence of a valve protection cap, as applicable, the proper cylinder, valve, and valve outlet, and that the cylinder is in the gas service as specified.

4.1.1.1 Rejection and condemnation. At receiving inspection, all cylinders shall be accepted for serviceability inspection and cylinder maintenance as required, except as follows:

(a) Cylinders with dimensions or capacities not as specified in the item description shall be rejected and returned to the Government.
(b) Cylinders with other than Government ownership markings shall be rejected and returned to the Government for disposition.
(c) Any cylinder that cannot be upgraded within a supplier's authorized capability for maintenance, repairing, or rebuilding shall be rejected and returned to the Government.

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and rebuilding are only performed by Bureau of Explosives authorized shops, and by a regular manufacturer of similar cylinders.

3.17 Cylinders subjected to fire. However, commercial cylinders not over 0.25 percent carbon nor over 0.90 percent manganese need not be reheat-treated but must pass hydrostatic retest. Acetylene cylinders not over 0.25 percent carbon nor over 0.90 percent manganese are inspected for damage to the porous filler. If no damage is found in the shell and the porous filler is undamaged, the cylinder may be returned to service without reheat treatment or hydrostatic test. All other cylinders are reheat treated, reconditioned, and tested in accordance with the CFR, Title 49, Paragraph 173.34 (g) before returning to gas service, Government cylinders subject to fire are not returned to service.

3.18 Condemned cylinders. Condemned cylinders will be forwarded to the U.S. Property Disposal Office for degrading and disposal. Condemned cylinders will include cylinders that are degraded by damage, corrosion, exposure to fire, cylinders specifically listed by Government or industry standards as cylinders not in accordance with current DOT regulations, or cylinders that have failed hydrostatic test. Condemned cylinders also include the rejected cylinder that cannot be maintained or repaired and returned to useful service.

3.19 Foreign cylinders. Foreign manufactured cylinders shall not be used in CONUS Government service. Whenever a foreign cylinder is identified, it will be marked "Foreign" and returned to the U.S. Property Disposal Office for degrading and disposal (see 5.1.8).

3.20 Item description. When a Government agency procures a commodity, it must first be identified by an item description and included as an approved Federal Item Identification arranged in narrative or tabular form determined appropriate. The item description includes specification and other reference numbers, when applicable. Unless specification numbers are qualified by a suffix or note, the item is in compliance with the latest revision or amendment.

4. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

4.1 Standard procedures. The general requirements for handling Government-owned cylinders cover the procedures for inspection, maintenance, and recharging required to assure that the container used with a gas commodity will maintain the purity set forth in the applicable

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(d) Cylinders made outside of the Continental United States shall be rejected and marked "condemned" and returned to the Government.

(e) Cylinders damaged and unworthy of repair or rebuild procedures shall be rejected and marked "condemned" and returned to the Government.

NOTE: All condemned cylinders, as defined above, shall be marked "condemned" with a justification and returned to the Government for disposition by the U.S. Property Disposal Office.

(f) Occasionally a cylinder will be unidentifiable and filled with gas. Caution must be practiced as the gas may be flammable or toxic to personnel. These cylinders may be rejected or condemned and returned to the Government for disposal.

4.1.2 Serviceability inspection. Each cylinder accepted at receiving inspection shall be inspected for serviceability in reference to the item description, the applicable DOT regulations, the assigned gas service, and as specified herein (see Table I). Accepted cylinders shall be forwarded for charging. Unacceptable cylinders, not meeting inspection levels, shall be scheduled for proper maintenance in accordance with 5.3. Records of scheduled maintenance shall be made on Forms DD-250 or similar tabulation. For detailed serviceability requirements see 5.2.

4.1.2.1 Rejection and condemnation. Cylinders that are unacceptable at serviceability inspection shall be tagged for proper maintenance. These cylinders shall meet serviceability standards before they shall be forwarded for recharging. Cylinders which cannot be upgraded by maintenance shall be rejected, tagged and returned to the Government. Any cylinder found to require condemnation by standards presented in 4.1.1 shall be marked "condemned" with justification and shall be returned to the Government for disposal.

4.1.3 Maintenance. Cylinders that have been scheduled for maintenance procedures, shall be serviced in accordance with the DOT Code of Federal Regulations and as specified herein. Heat treatment, repair, and

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rebuilding of cylinders shall only be accomplished by facilities approved by the Bureau of Explosives, as applicable. Each cylinder after maintenance, shall pass the applicable detailed serviceability requirements of Section 5 before returning to compressed gas service. For detailed maintenance requirements, see 5.3.

4.1.3.1 Rejected and condemned cylinders. Any cylinder that cannot be reconditioned to meet serviceability standards of 5.2 shall be rejected at maintenance, tagged for repair or rebuild or marked "condemned", and returned to the Government for proper disposition.

4.1.4 Cylinder charging. Each cylinder shall be evacuated before charging except for acetylene, liquified petroleum gases and other fuel gas mixtures. For these services the weight of residual gas is retained and becomes a part of the functional base weight for determining the weight of gas required for charging. Charging shall follow immediately after evacuating or purging without opening the manifold to atmospheric air to control possible contamination of the specified gas commodity. Cylinder charging shall be handled in accordance with 5.4.

4.1.4.1 Rejection and condemnation. Any cylinder that leaks at the inlet threads or through a damaged valve body must have its gas pressure exhausted and returned to maintenance for necessary repair. Any valve leak that can be sealed by normal tightening of the stem seal or packing gland shall be acceptable for charging. Any cylinder, except for chlorine service, with oversized neck threads causing leakage with a standard valve will be rejected and condemned (see chlorine cylinder maintenance). Cylinders that display any instability of structure such as bulging or leakage in any way shall be exhausted, rejected, marked "condemned", and returned to the Government for disposal.

4.2 Special procedures. When a gas commodity contract is written to include the servicing of Government cylinders on a cost per unit of volume, or unit of weight base, the only additional expense allowed shall be the cost of returning Government property to the procuring agency. This procedure has been established in servicing fluorocarbon contracts. The Government cylinder shall be inspected and serviced in accordance wth the requirements of the Code of Federal Regulations, Title 49, and the CGA pamphlets referenced herein. The contractor shall exercise the same procedures and practices used in maintaining his own cylinders. When a deviation in procedure in the contractor's standard operation is

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introduced, notice shall be forwarded to the Government contracting officer for approval, before Government cylinders are processed in filling valid or proposed contracts. When the contractor's plant processes are candidate for the above service procurement-commodity contracts, his operation shall be judged as acceptable only when it meets the requirements of this standard or an approved detailed process equivalent or better than specified herein.

5. DETAILED REQUIREMENTS

5.1 Receiving inspection. The supplier shall inspect the Government-owned cylinders received for charging, or reconditioning in accordance with the item description. The number of acceptable cylinders should be recorded to identify a specific contract. Cylinders not acceptable shall be returned to the Government agency. The receiving inspection is intended to limit the handling of cylinders which are not reclaimable for use in a contractor work order. At the discretion of the contractor, procedures outlines in receiving inspection may be incorporated in a comprehensive serviceability inspection.

5.1.1 Cylinder identification permanent markings. Each cylinder shall have its permanent markings inspected for proper identification, legibility, and accuracy. Permanent markings shall be embossed, stamped or etched into the shoulder of 3A or 3AA cylinders and into a place of high visibility on low pressure DOT series 4 and 8 cylinders. Cylinders with improper markings, illegible markings, or inaccurate markings shall be scheduled for maintenance, as applicable, or shall be rejected and returned to the Government agency.

5.1.1.1 Serial number. The serial number on the cylinder shall be inspected for legibility as the identification number for the specific cylinder. The serial number is placed on the cylinder at the time of manufacture and is registered with the Bureau of Explosives. Duplicates are never issued and numbers shall display no sign of tampering or change.

5.1.1.2 DOT specification and service pressure. The cylinder DOT specification and service pressure markings shall be inspected to assure that the cylinder is compatible with the requirements of the item description or contract. The cylinder shall be in accordance with the Code of Federal Regulations for the intended use. The service

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pressure is related to the sidewall thickness and the level of proof testing at fabrication, and is used as an index for hydrostatic testing throughout the cylinder life. Nonconforming cylinders shall be returned to the Government agency for disposition.

5.1.1.3 Identification symbol. The cylinder shall be inspected for its identification symbol which identifies the manufacturer, the actual owner or the user of the cylinder, as applicable. The responsible party is registered with the Bureau of Explosives, and is also a source of technical information regarding the date, material and process of manufacture for the cylinder. This information is necessary for rebuild and maintenance of the cylinder throughout its useful life.

5.1.1.4 Government ownership. The cylinder shall be inspected for markings denoting Government ownership. Markings identifying Government ownership are as follows: U.S Government, U.S. Property, WD, AF DA, USA, USN, N, US, or the name of a DOD or other Government agency impressed into the shoulder of the cylinder or embossed on the marking. A Military or Federal specification number impressed into the shoulder of the cylinder will also establish Government ownership. Cylinders not identified as US Government property shall be returned to the Government agency for proper disposition.

5.1.1.5 Nonshatterability (NONSHAT) (see 3.11). When nonshatterability is specified, each cylinder shall be inspected for identification markings or fabrication assuring the nonshatterable properties of the steel used to make the vessel. Nonshatterable properties shall be assured when the following markings are established:

(a) Permanent marking, NONSHAT, SHATTERPROOF or NONSHATTERABLE.
(b) Cylinders with the following specification permanent markings, SPS 843, (INT), (SPS 1022 INT), 51-C-26 (INT), 51-C-41 (INT), 51-C-26 or 51-C-27. In addition, cylinders dated after 6-44 and stamped 51-C-31 or 51-C-31 (INT).
(c) Any cylinder fabricated to 3AA Specification from ASA 4130 steel fabricated in accordance with 3.11 and 3.11.1 shall also be considered nonshatterable.

Cylinders that are found to be nonshatterable by these guidelines, but not permanently marked as in (a) above, shall be scheduled for marking "NONSHAT" by stamping or etching with a template. Letters shall be not less than 3/8 inch high and deep enough to be legible through the finish coat of paint.

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5.1.1.6 Tare weight. Each cylinder used in liquified gas service shall be weighed before each charging. Cylinders without permanently marked tare weights shall be scheduled for weighing and marking at maintenance.

5.1.1.7 Water capacity. Water capacity is an optional marking on Government-owned cylinders (see 3.9).

5.1.1.8 Periodic test status. Cylinders in Government service shall be inspected for valid or expired periodic test dates. Cylinders in noncorrosive liquified gas service may qualify for external visual examination in lieu of hydrostatic testing. Cylinders with expired test dates shall be scheduled for testing or examination as applicable. Test dates followed by a star indicate that a specific cylinder is in a specific service on a 10 year rather than on a 5 year retest program. Test dates followed with a (+) sign have been approved for special filling limits 10 percent above the marked service pressure. Government acetylene cylinders require periodic requalification testing after 20 years service.

5.1.2 Dimensions. Government-owned cylinders shall be inspected for cylinder dimensions or capacity in accordance with the item description. Cylinders rejected for excessive variation with the item description shall be reported to the Government agency.

5.1.3 Color code, paint, and stenciling. The cylinders shall be inspected for proper color coding and stenciling in accordance with MIL-STD-101 as specified in the item description. Cylinders with improper color, peeling paint, and improper or illegible stenciling shall be scheduled for external maintenance.

5.1.4 Cylinder valve protection cap. Each cylinder designed for a protection cap shall be inspected for the presence of a valve protection cap that will run free on its threads and be free of cracks or dents. Cylinders lacking caps or with damaged caps shall have them replaced or scheduled for necessary maintenance. Cylinders with capacity less than 625 cubic inches capacity do not require a valve protection cap in Government service except for medical gas applications.

5.1.5 Cylinder valves. Each cylinder shall be inspected for a functional valve threaded into its neck threads. Broken valves or obviously nonfunctional valves shall be scheduled for replacement at maintenance.

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5.1.6 Change in service. When specified in the contract, cylinders at receiving inspection which have an acceptable DOT specification and service pressure in accordance with the requirements of the item description, but in a different noncorrosive gas service shall be scheduled for change of service procedures.

5.1.7 Damaged cylinders. Cylinders shall be inspected for bent or corn footrings in low pressure applications and for loose flanges in DOT 3A or 3AA applications. These types of defects shall be scheduled for maintenance in general metal working shops where the pressure bearing portion of the cylinder is not subject to the heat of welding activity. Repair work requiring independent welds of less than 3 inches or rebuild work requiring welds greater than 3 inches in length on the pressurized portion of the cylinder shall be scheduled for maintenance in shops with proper Bureau of Explosives authorization. Cylinders showing evidence of being subjected to fire shall be condemned and returned to the Government agency for disposal. When proper repair, rebuild, or remanufacture is not available a cylinder requiring such maintenance shall be rejected and returned to the Government agency.

5.1.8 Foreign cylinders. Foreign cylinders generally cannot meet the requirements of the Code of Federal Regulations because records of fabrication are not available. Foreign cylinders found at receiving inspection in CONUS service shall be condemned and returned to the Government agency for disposal.

5.1.9 Substandard cylinders. Cylinders that are listed by Government agencies or in Industrial publications, declaring them in nonconformance to the current Code of Federal Regulations shall be rejected, marked "condemned", and returned to the Government for disposition.

5.1.10 Recording of services at receiving inspection. Receiving inspection should include the number of cylinders received in duplicate (DD Form 250) indicating acceptance or rejection.

5.2 Serviceability inspection.

5.2.1 Residual gas and moisture control. Cylinders shall be inspected for residual gas pressure. The level of pressure shall be 5 psi (great enough to produce an audible hiss when the valve is slightly cracked open). Any cylinder suspected of containing water shall be inverted and drained of its contents for not less than 10 minutes, and shall be considered an open cylinder. Cylinders with

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low pressure, negative pressure, or with open valves shall be scheduled for cleaning and drying, or purging at maintenance, as applicable. If the audible hiss method is used, a slip of paper shall be used to insure that any sound is due to a positive pressure and not a vacuum when the valve is slightly opened. For general applications, a cylinder containing 5 psi of pressure from residual gas will be acceptable for evacuation and refilling. Cylinders such as acetylene, liquified petroleum and fuel gas mixtures may be returned partially filled with gas which is of value to the Government. This gas shall be retained and included with the cylinder tare weight to make up the base weight for cylinder charging. All other cylinders partially filled with gas, shall have their contents bled off and disposed of in accordance with current environmental requirements. The residual gas shall be considered as waste by the Government and may be reclaimed at the discretion of the gas supplier. Gases included are chlorine, anhydrous amonia, and flurorcarbon refrigerants, as applicable.

5.2.2 External inspection. Each cylinder shall be inspected externally by placing the cylinder in a good light, tilting to reflect light and slowly rolling for a complete revolution. The entire surface shall be inspected for excessive denting, pitting, gouges, bulging or corrosion. Rejection shall be in accordance with the contractor's standard practice, but damage shall not exceed rejection levels established in the CGA pamphlet C-6. Particular attention should be given to identifying the cylinder with an arc-burn generally found in the welding trade. Cylinders in helium, argon, oxygen, acetylene, or LPG gas, service with an arc-burn shall be condemned, because there will be a change in the crystal structure of the steel at the point of damage and immediately around the area. This type of damage is hazardous and cannot be repaired. Condemnation of the cylinder with an arc-burn is mandatory. Evidence of grinding out a defect on a cylinder after manufacture shall be cause for rejection. It should be noted that the manufacturers of high-pressure cylinders often grind the shoulder areas after necking to remove ridges or tooling marks solely for appearances. Some cylinder drawing processes are exposed to the atmosphere and oxides forming on the surface crack in cooling. These cracks show up in X-ray examination of the cylinder shell. A longitudinal grinding of several mils depth removes the offending oxide and allows inspection of the base metal. These grinding marks will be exposed when the cylinder is stripped and are identified by their longitudinal pattern, but are not cause for rejection or condemnation.

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5.2.2.1 Paint inspection. The condition of the paint on each cylinder shall be inspected for peeling or chalking. The cylinder color shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-101 and the specific item description. Cylinders displaying a random pattern of chipping or peeling shall be stripped and repainted. Cylinders displaying localized chipping from a specific use pattern may be spot painted to seal the denuded metal. When a cylinder requires coverage of more than 10 percent of its area, stripping and repainting will be justified. Protective caps shall be considered a part of the cylinder package to be repainted with a cylinder needing paint in the maintenance process.

5.2.2.2 Valve protection cap inspection. Each valve protection cap shall be inspected for cracks, dents, or a mismatch in size. Caps with internal threads that are stripped or damaged making hand mounting on the cylinder impractical after a wire brush removal of rust and corrosion shall be rejected. Hydrocarbon lubrication is not allowed on cap or flange threads, however, fire resistant fluorocarbon or silicon lubricants are permissible and recommended for cylinders subject to weather or high humidity conditions.

5.2.3 Valves and safety devices. Each valve shall be inspected for damaged hand wheels, bent or leaking stems, and damaged or nicked outlet seats and threads. Further inspection shall be made for dirt, grease, or insect residue. Packing nuts shall be snug to control leakage and bonnet nuts shall be locked tight. Valve inlet threads should expose more than one thread between the cylinder neck and the wrenching boss of the valve. The valve shall be functional and shall control the gas flow at the valve seat when residual gas is checked. Valve outlets shall be in accordance with MIL-V-2 and the applicable specification sheet as specified in the item description. Damaged or faulty valves shall be scheduled for maintenance or replacement in accordance with MIL-V-2.

5.2.3.1 Safety devices. Safety devices shall be inspected for compliance with the CGA pamphlet S-1.1. Rejected or faulty safety devices shall be scheduled for maintenance or replacement. Safety devices that are integral with the cylinder (acetylene or chlorine) shall be inspected for leaks or extruded fusible metal. Faulty devices shall be rejected and scheduled for maintenance or replacement. Fusible plugs integral with a valve body found faulty at inspection shall

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require valve rejection and shall be scheduled for replacement at maintenance. Cylinder valves with Style 1, frangible disk safety devices shall be inspected for evidence of leakage and burst limits in accordance with the service pressure identification markings on the cylinder. Faulty disks shall be scheduled for replacement with a manufacturer's complete unit (cap, washer, and disk), as applicable. Cylinder valves with Styles 2 and 3 fusible plug safety devices shall be inspected for leakage or extrusion of the fusible metal. Faulty or rejected fusible plugs shall be scheduled for replacement in accordance with the item description, (temperature range) and requirements specified in the CGA pamphlet S-1.1. Cylinder valves with Styles 4 and 5 combination safety devices (frangible disk backed with fusible metal) shall be inspected for signs of extrusion of the fusible metal at the relief holes. Unstable devices shall be rejected and scheduled for replacement with a new complete unit Style 4 or Style 5 when required or with the proper Style 1 device in accordance with MIL-V-2. Combination safety devices are required by the Government for hydrogen, carbon monoxide, sulfur, hexafluoride and medical gas services. Combination devices are acceptable in high pressure applications on cylinders with marked service pressures from 1800 psi to 2400 psi. Combination devices are prohibited on cylinders to be filled 10 percent above the marked service pressure. These cylinders are marked with a (+) sign following the last periodic test date, and shall be equipped with a Style 1 (frangible disk only) safety device with a rated burst pressure not to exceed the minimum required test pressure of the cylinder with which the device is used. Cylinders with Style 7 (spring relief) safety devices shall be inspected for evidence of leakage. Spring relief safety devices are utilized in Government service on cylinders in liquified petroleum and fluorocarbon gas service. Faulty safety devices shall be cause for valve rejection and shall be scheduled for replacement in accordance with MIL-V-2 and the item description.

5.2.4 Inspection of flanges. Flanges on high-pressure cylinders shall be inspected for tightness of fit. These flanges are either pressed into place, sweat fit, or peened tight. Heat cannot be applied to the cylinder in resweating these accessories for fear of annealing. Flanges shall be scheduled for peening or for flange replacement when peening would deform the cylinder neck to fill a stretched flange. Any cracked flange or a flange with damaged threads shall be replaced in cylinder maintenance. Flanges on low pressure cylinders including acetylene cylinders are welded to the base metal of the cylinder shell. Acetylene cylinder flanges provide drilled and tapped holes for removable safety devices in their shoulders (see 5.2.3). The removal and repair of

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flanges on low-pressure cylinders shall be a major rebuild operation carried out by shops registered and approved by the Bureau of Explosives. When approved services are not available to the contractor the cylinder shall be rejected, tagged, and returned to the Government empty for repair or disposal.

5.2.5 Inspection of footrings. DOT specifications provide for welded or brazed seams in fabrication of low-pressure cylinders and due to the thin construction in the bottom areas are provided with footrings welded in place. Footrings shall be inspected and scheduled for maintenance when they are deformed or when rings are cracked or broken in any place where the seam is not a part of the cylinder proper. Welding or brazing of the footring is permissible so long as the cylinder is only subject to heat controlled by water or steam. Welded seams on the cylinder proper shall be repaired only by Bureau of Explosives approved shops. Maintenance of flanges shall be performed in accordance with the CFR, Title 49. If authorized repair or rebuild services are not offered by, or available to, the contractor, the cylinder shall be rejected, tagged, and returned to the Government agency. High-pressure cylinders are not provided with footrings as welding or brazing is not allowed in DOT specifications 3A or 3AA for cylinders with service pressures above 500 psig. These cylinders have round bottoms and require fixtures to hold them in upright position, or the crown of their bases are bumped-back to provide a ring at the side wall as a standing surface for upright stability. 3A and 3AA seamless cylinders of thin wall construction with service pressures under 500 psig are provided with welded footrings for cylinder bottom protection and shall be repaired only by authorized services or by a manufacturer of similar cylinders.

5.2.6 Periodic test date inspection. Each cylinder shall have its periodic test date inspected for serviceability. Cylinders with serviceable test dates shall be forwarded to general cylinder inspection and cylinders with expired dates shall be grouped for retest as specified herein. 3A and 3AA cylinders in high pressure service are hydrostatic tested at 5/3 times the service pressure and the permanent and elastic expansions are measured for acceptable ratios. Approved cylinders shall be dated for 5 year service periods. When specified in the contract, a 10 year service period shall be established and marked with a star (*) after the test date (see 5.3.1.1.2). Low pressure cylinders made by welding are hydrostatic tested at 2 times the marked service pressure and are measured for permanent and total volumetric expansion ratios. Approved

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cylinders are dated for a 5 year service period. When low pressure cylinders are used for a gas service commercially free of corroding components, the test period may be extended from 5 years to 10 years. DOT 3A, DOT 3AA or DOT 4AA480 specification cylinders in noncorrosive anhydrous ammonia service may be retested every 10 years instead of every 5 years repeating the hydrostatic test method used in making the cylinder. DOT 4B, DOT 4BA, DOT 4BW and DOT 4E specification cylinders in exclusive noncorrosive gas service, such as liquified petroleum, fluorocarbon refrigerants and fuel gas mixtures as listed in the CFR, Title 49, Para. 173.34 (g) may have the original test period extended to 12 years. These cylinders may be retested by the modified hydrostatic test (2 times the service pressure without expansion measurements and examined for leaks or other harmful defects). Approved cylinders shall be marked following the test date with the symbols denoting a 7 year service period. The CFR Title 49 Para. (10) lists cylinder specifications in noncorrosive gas services which qualify for external visual inspection in lieu of hydrostatic testing. Cylinders approved by external visual inspection shall be marked with the symbol E after the test date denoting a 5 year service period. At any time, cylinders maintained by external visual inspection may be hydrostatic tested in accordance with the applicable DOT fabrication specification and approved for a 10 year service period due to the noncorrosive quality of the gas service. This standard requires 10 year requalification for Government acetylene cylinders. The CFR does not require periodic control of acetylene cylinders, but a periodic requalification program assures that Government cylinders will receive a minimum of maintenance for safe use and handling. Cylinders shall be separated into the following catagories and scheduled for periodic testing as applicable.

5.2.6.1 Hydrostatic testing.

(a) 3A and 3AA cylinders in high and low pressure services with expired service periods. When specified in the contract, wall stress evaluation shall be made and approved cylinders shall be marked with a star (*) for a 10 year service period.
(b) Chlorine cylinders with expired 5 year service periods.
(c) Cylinders used overseas and returned for CONUS service.
(d) Cylinders under reconditioning contracts.
(e) When specified in the contract, cylinders requiring hydrostatic testing for storage or overseas with less than 1 year service period remaining.

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(f) Low pressure cylinders with expired test periods may be retested either by hydrostatic test in accordance with the fabrication specification or by modified hydrostatic test when authorized by specification and service listed in the CFR and identified by the Symbol S after the test date.

5.2.6.2 External visual inspection. DOT 3A, 3AA, 4AA480, 4B, 4BA, 8W and 4E cylinders in low pressure noncorrosive gas services as listed in the CFR with expired test periods may be evaluated by external visual inspection in lieu of the hydrostatic test method applicable and are identified by the symbol E after the test date.

5.2.6.3 Acetylene cylinders requiring requalification. Each acetylene cylinder shall be inspected for a valid 20 year periodic qualification date. Any cylinder with a fabrication date or a requalification date older than 20 years shall be scheduled for requalification before returning to gas service (see 5.3.1.4). Acetylene cylinders with valid periodic dates shall be scheduled for general maintenance as required in accordance with 5.3.3.

5.2.7 General internal cylinder evaluation. At general internal evaluation cylinders accepted at receiving inspection not requiring valve removal except for sulfur hexafluoride and chlorine (see 5.2.8 and 5.2.9) shall be inspected for serviceability by the following procedures. Acetylene cylinders shall be evaluated in accordance with 5.3.3 for general service.

5.2.7.1 The hammer test. Each cylinder shall be subjected to a hammer test to assure viable structural integrity and that internally the surface is free of heavy corrosion residue. The clear ringing sound of acceptable cylinders will readily separate out the cylinder with a dull or dead response. Dull or dead sounding cylinders or a cylinder with a peculiar sound shall be scheduled for devalving, drop-light inspection, and maintenance, as applicable. The hammer test is a recommended pre-filling gas cylinder inspection procedure which is mandatory for all 3A, 3AA, 3AX, and 3AAX cylinders in accordance with the Department of Transportation regulations. Cylinders with heavy corrosion deposits will have a muted or "dead" ring when struck a light blow with a wrench or light hammer. Cylinders to be inspected must be standing vertically without touching other cylinders or objects which might deaden the sound. A pigtail connecting the cylinder to a manifold is allowable. Strike each cylinder a light blow with a one-half-pound machinists ball peen hammer, wrench, or similar tool on the side wall about one-half or two-thirds down the cylinder. The blow

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must be light, as all cylinders will ring if hit hard enough. If there is a thud instead of a ring or if the ring dies out quickly (in one or two seconds), the cylinder shall be set aside for closer examination. A "dead" cylinder can best be simulated by filling an empty cylinder without valve with several inches of dry sand. This cylinder can be used as a periodic check for the sound of a "dead" cylinder. If the ring of any cylinder is substantially different in tone or quality from the ring of other cylinders of the same size being hammer tested, the cylinder shall be rejected. Hammer testing must be performed on the internally inspected cylinder since severe intergranular and transgranular corrosion can also deaden the ring. This very hazardous form of corrosion is invisible to the naked eye and can be verified only by a microscopic inspection of the affected portion of cylinder wall.

5.2.7.2 Odor test. Any cylinder except those in poisonous or toxic gas service shall be subject to an odor or sniff test. A residual pressure is necessary or an odorless inert gas must be introduced into the cylinder being inspected to carry out this test. An experienced operator should be able to seperate acceptable cylinders with odorless effluent gas from rejected cylinders with odor bearing gas with contamination levels as low as 50 ppm. Odor bearing cylinders shall be scheduled for devalving, cleaning, and drying at maintenance, as applicable. This test shall be limited to cylinders for compressed air, argon, nitrogen, helium, oxygen, carbon dioxide, and their mixtures. It can only be used for cylinders in flammable gas service if the flammable gas is carefully purged out and replaced with an odor-free inert gas or dry air before the inspection is performed. It is normally not performed on cylinders from which the valve is to be removed. The following procedure for performing the odor test is recommended for use not only when cylinders are changed in service but also prior to each refill of cylinders. CAUTION: Do not place the nose directly into the venting gas stream and do not take deep breaths. Discontinue "sniffing" any gas at the first indication of irritation of the nasal passages or at any sign of physical discomfort. Some contaminants are extremely irritating, poisonous or toxic and can cause physical injury. Standing at arm's length from the cylinder to be tested and with the valve pointing to the left (to the right for left-handed individuals) "crack" the valve for the briefest possible moment and immediately reclose it. The valve must point away from the hand and arm used to operate the valve. Sniff cautiously without approaching the cylinder. If no odor is detected, slowly open the valve until a gas flow is heard or felt (pass the hand rapidly past the outlet) and proceed to the next step. Be prepared at all times to close the valve quickly. With the valve open to a slight flow of gas, place the cupped hand in the gas stream, close the cylinder valve, and cautiously sniff the hand.

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If no foreign odor is detected, proceed to the next step. Reopen the valve to a slight flow and, with a quick fanning motion of the hand, fan the gas from the cylinder toward the nose. If no odor is detected, continue the fanning motion and move progressively nearer the cylinder. If at any time during the inspection process an odor is detected, an attempt should be made to classify it such as "acrid", "sweet", rotten egg", "glue-like", etc., s this will help in the selection of the appropriate cleaning process. The ability to detect and classify odors is so important in the detection and identification of contaminants, persons assigned this task must be able to detect foreign odors in gases vented from cylinders. Such persons should be questioned as to their ability to detect odors. The ability to pick out a known contaminant cylinder from a group of noncontaminated ones shall be demonstrated by test. Persons temporarily unable to detect or classify odors because of head colds, hay fever, etc., shall be excluded from the assignment of inspecting cylinders for the presence of odorous contaminants.

5.2.8 Sulfur hexafluoride cylinder internal inspection. Each cylinder in sulfur hexafluoride service shall be bled to zero pressure in accordance with environmental requirements, devalved and subjected to internal inspection by droplight. Sulfur hexafluoride cylinders internally shall be free of oil, grease and rust to the reduced metal level and shall be equilavent to the rust free examples in ASTM D 2200 - Pictoral Surface Preparation Standards For Painting Steel Surfaces - Standard B-SA-1. Cylinders requiring internal cleaning shall be scheduled for maintenance procedures in accordance with special handling 5.3.5, (c) and (d) specified herein.

5.2.9 Chlorine cylinder internal inspection. Each chlorine cylinder shall be bled to zero pressure in accordance with environmental requirements, and shall have its valve removed and internally inspected. Before charging, the cylinder shall be subjected to internal inspection by droplight test to assure that corrosion has not damaged the integrity of the cylinder wall, bottom, or its neck inlet threads. Before charging, the chlorine cylinder shall be subjected to a hammer test. Cylinders with corroded sidewalls, cylinders with eroded female neck threads, and cylinders with a dull response or unusual sounding at hammer testing shall be rejected and scheduled for applicable maintenance. Cylinders rejected for general internal corrosion shall pass hydrostatic testing after corrosion products have been removed before returning to regular gas service.

5.2.10 Rejection and condemnation. At serviceability inspection each cylinder received will have been examined for charging, maintenance and repair or for storage in accordance with the item description.

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Cylinders shall be accepted for service with a specified gas commodity application, when the integrity of the cylinder is assured to be in accordance with the applicable DOT specification and the cylinder is assured to maintain the purity level of the gas of specified use. Cylinders not acceptable by this standard shall be processed for applicable maintenance to restore acceptability in accordance with the item description. Cylinders that cannot be restored by approved maintenance procedures, shall be condemned and returned to the Government agency. Unrepairable valves are Government property and shall be returned to the Government.

5.2.11 Recording of required services at serviceability inspection. Serviceability inspection requires the listing of the number of cylinders inspected on duplicate (DD Form 250) indicating acceptance, rejection, and required maintenance. The DD Form 250 shall identify the activities required in process.

5.3 Cylinder maintenance. Cylinders received and found to be deficient at inspection or at charging shall be scheduled for necessary maintenance before returning to compressed gas service. A record of maintenance shall be kept current on DD Forms 250. After scheduled maintenance has been performed, the cylinder shall pass inspection standard in accordance with 5.1 and 5.2 of this standard. Cylinders should be grouped as follows:

(a) Periodic testing.
    (1) Cylinders requiring hydrostatic testing.
    (2) Cylinders requiring external visual examination.
    (3) Acetylene cylinders requiring 20 year requalification.
(b) General cylinder maintenance.
(c) General acetylene cylinder maintenance.
(d) Chlorine cylinders.
(e) Cylinders requiring special handling.
(f) Cylinders requiring external surface maintenance.

5.3.1 Periodic testing. Cylinders in maintenance for periodic testing are generally cylinders with expired or invalid periodic test dates. Exceptions would be a requirement for 100 percent testing specified in a reconditioning contract or a cylinder which has undergone rebuild procedures. Cylinders shall be subjected either to hydrostatic testing or external visual inspection. Acetylene cylinders shall be examined both externally and internally for requalification of acetylene cylinders as specified herein.

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5.3.1.1 The hydrostatic test. The hydrostatic test shall be performed in accordance with the Compressed Gas Association Pamphlet C-1, "Hydrostatic Testing". To pass the hydrostatic test, a 3A or 3AA cylinder subjected to 5/3 times its marked service pressure internally shall have a permanent expansion which will be less than 10 percent of its total expansion. The cylinder elastic expansion (EE) will be its total expansion less its permanent expansion. Low pressure welded cylinders shall be hydrostatic tested at two times the marked service pressure. Permanent volumetric expansion must not exceed 10 percent of the total volumetric expansion. DOT 4B, DOT 4BA, DOT 4BW and DOT 4E cylinders used in services such as liquified petroleum, fluorocarbon refrigerants and fuel gas mixtures or as listed in the CFR Title 49 Para. 173.34 (9) may be tested by the modified hydrostatic method at two times the marked service pressure and examined for leaks or other defects without measurement of the volumetric expansion. Cylinders approved by the modified hydrostatic method shall have a retest period of 7 years and shall be permanently marked with the symbol S after the test date. The hydrostatic test shall always be preceded by a droplight test (see 5.3.2.1). Any cylinder displaying contamination such as grease, corrosion, or oxidation deposits shall be scheduled for cleaning or mechanical removal of the offending deposits before hydrostatic testing. Cylinders that fail at droplight test procedures or cylinders that fail hydrostatic test requirements shall be rejected, marked condemned, and returned to the Government agency for disposal. Cylinders passing internal visual examination and cylinders approved in hydrostatic testing shall be drained and dried in accordance with 5.3.2.4 and revalved as quickly as practical.

5.3.1.1.1 Special filling limit test. DOT 3A and 3AA cylinders that meet the requirements of the CFR, Title 49, 173.302 may be marked with a (+) sign and filled to a pressure 10 percent above the marked service pressure. These requirements including a wall stress analysis, shall be made at each retest of a given cylinder. High pressure cylinders DOT 3A and 3AA specifications, size 9 inches x 51 inches, with a nominal water capacity of 2640 cubic inches may be tested for special filling limits, 10 percent above the marked service pressure (see special filling limits CFR Title 49, 173.43 and as specified herein). Approved cylinders shall be marked permanently by a (+) mark following the last periodic hydrostatic test date. If a cylinder has been in service at the special filling limit and marked with a (+) and is retested by regular hydrostatic test, the date is not to be followed by a (+) and it shall be returned to service at the marked service pressure. Government cylinders specified for special filling limit shall

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be restricted to cylinders manufactured after 1960, except for cylinders made by Taylor Wharton or Harrisburg Steel Co. which shall be limited to cylinders made since 1920. The practice of testing for special filling limits should be reserved for use only when justification for the additional capacity is made by the procuring agency. Each manufacturer controls his production by a given "K" factor and a maximum Elastic Expansion (EE) at hydrostatic testing. This information is listed below. K factors shall be used to calculate the average or the maximum wall stress when a corresponding cylinder is retested to be approved for filling 10 percent above the marked service pressure.

Mfg & Date Cylinder	Type size - Cu in	K-Factor	Max (EE)
Pressed steel TK.	3AA2015 - 2640	1.24×10^{-7}	220
1960 * present	3AA2265 - 2640	1.24×10^{-7}	221
Harrisburg Steel	3A2015 - 2640	1.31×10^{-7}	178
Taylor-Wharton	3AA2015 - 2640	1.30×10^{-7}	220
	3AA2265 - 2640	1.30×10^{-7}	220
Marison	3AA2015 - 2640	1.30×10^{-7}	220
Cylinder	3AA2265 - 2640	1.32×10^{-7}	230

NOTE: Before 1960, Pressed Steel Tank Company made many cylinders from plate stock. Though these cylinders are reliable at marked service pressures, they shall not be tested and used at 10 percent over marked service pressures.

5.3.1.1.2 10 year periodic test. DOT 3A and 3AA cylinders that have been used exclusively in a noncorrosive gas service can be inspected in accordance with the CFR and be approved for 10 year retest periods. When specified in the contract, Government-owned cylinders may be approved for 10 year test periods in accordance with the CFR, Title 49, 173.43. This privilege should only be used when the history of a cylinder is known or by special testing. Historic information is not generally available for Government-owned cylinders. Special application may justify 10 year retesting such as overseas service. DOT 3A and 3AA cylinders approved for 10 year periodic testing shall have the test date followed by a star (*) permanently marked in the metal of the shoulder immediately following the test date.

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5.3.1.2 External visual inspection. Cylinders made in accordance with, and used exclusively in the noncorrosive gas services listed in the CFR Title 49, Para. 173.34 (10), may be evaluated by an external visual inspection in lieu of the periodic hydrostatic retest. External visual inspection shall be required 5 years after the first inspection and periodically at the 5 year intervals thereafter. Procedures and requirements shall be in accordance with the Compressed Gas Association amphlet C-6, "Standards for Visual Inspection of Gas Cylinders". Cylinders pproved at external visual inspection, shall be permanently marked with the month and year of the inspection date followed with the letter "E".

5.3.1.3 Acetylene cylinder 20 year requalification. In addition to the requirements specified in the Code of Federal Regulations for acetylene cylinder service, the Government's acetylene cylinders shall have the external shell- and the porous fillers examined at 20 year intervals after manufacture (see 3.13). Approved cylinders shall be permanently marked and requalified for 20 years of additional service as specified herein.

5.3.1.3.1 External visual inspection of acetylene cylinders. Acetylene cylinders are low-pressure cylinders tested at 500 psi, and shall be inspected in accordance with CGA Pamphlet C-6 "Standards for Visual Inspection of Cylinders". Rejected cylinders shall be marked "rejected" and returned to the Government for disposition.

5.3.1.3.2 Internal acetylene cylinder maintenance. An acetylene cylinder that displays carbon deposit in the well under the valve shall be examined for depth of penetration. If the penetration is less than 1 inch of fel- filler, replace with a new felt filler. If the penetration of carbon extends beyond 1 inch, it must be assumed that the monolithic filler is also penetrated and filling with acetylene will be inhibited. Cylinders with carbon deposits penetrating more than 1 inch of well felt shall be rejected, marked condemned, and returned to a U.S. Property Office for disposal.

5.3.1.3.3 Internal acetylene cylinder filler examination. The porous filler of an acetylene cylinder will be either monolithic or non-monolithic in construction (see 3.5.4). The nonmonolithic type will be made by packing nonreactive materials like asbestos fibers, charcoal, or felt fibers into the cylinder interior to create finely divided spaces to trap small volumes of acetone. Nonmonolethic fillers have a tendency to sag in an upright cylinder allowing enlarged spaces at the shoulder area. Monolithic fillers either use a binder-like Portland

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cement or are made of a refracting material like sodium silicate. Monolithic fillers are normally fixed in the cylinder shell, unless chemical or mechanical breakdown takes place from extraneous sources resulting in softening, crumbling, or loosening the porous structure. A common source of cylinder damage arises from rough handling where the impacting of the cylinder shell externally will cause extreme sagging or crushing of the cellular structure of the monolithic filler. Another distructive process results when water is entrained with the acetylene or when a cylinder valve is left open. The nonmonolithic fillers tend to lose their structural characteristics and may become soft and similar to putty. The finely divided spaces are lost generally or the filler will take at a stratified level and will inhibit the free absorption of acetylene by the acetone at lower levels in the cylinder. Water in the monolithic filler is not as destructive to the filler material as it is to nonmonolithic materials. Bakeout of the monolithic filler usually restores the original cylinder function. However, water tends to collect and form a crust of crumbled or crushed particles in a cylinder subjected to rough use or at the least a stratified layer of pores will be water filled across the cylinder diameter. A waterlogged layer will inhibit free transfer of acetylene to and from the acetone deep in the cylinder.

(a) Examination tools. Tools needed for satisfactory inspection include a 0.060 inch stainless steel wire probe with an angle point for optimum reach through the valve and fusible plug openings, a series of right-angle thickness gages in 0.030 inch increments from 0.060 inch to 0.240 inch made from corrosion-resistant steel and capable of passing through the fusible plugholes, a small mirror, and a concentrated light source to complete an adequate inspection kit.

(b) General filler examination. The cylinder with valve and fusible plugs removed, as applicable, shall have its filler inspected with the angle wire probe. Insert the probe through the various holes and press firmly in all directions. A feel for satisfactory structure must be gained related to the type of filler being inspected. A nonmonolithic filler will present firm resistance, whereas a monolithic filler will present a rigid type of resistance. Do not impact or jab the filler with the probe. Indentation into the filler up to a quarter of an inch with positive resistance is indicative of a satisfactory structural condition. Soft, pasty, crushed, or broken fillers (deep crevices) are indications of fillers unsatisfactory for further use. Fillers found to be questionable shall be further examined with the dental mirror and the light source. Fillers that probe deeply or reveal positive degradation of structural integrity at inspection, either by chemical or mechanical process, shall be rejected and marked "condemned", and returned to the Government for disposition.

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(c) Filler end clearance. Nonmonolithic fillers are packed fillers and will tend to sag in normal use. Thus, the only measurement to be taken in these cylinders is at the top end. Monolithic fillers are rigid and although allowance is made for cureback, measurement must be made top and bottom and totaled to determine satisfactory condition. However, side wall clearance measurements need not be taken as diameter cureback has been observed to be in ratio to the actual length of the specific filler. As a result, it is concluded that if total end-clearances are acceptable the diameter clearances for the same cylinder will also be acceptable.

(d) Filler clearance measurement. Each cylinder filler shall be measured and grouped with cylinders whose filler lengths are in 5-inch increments with the largest fillers being over 40 inches. The total end clearance for this group shall not exceed 0.250 inch regardless of length. Fillers of shorter lengths shall be measured for end-clearance by identifying the smallest thickness gage with a no-go application at the top end of a nonmonolithic-filler or by the sum of the smallest gages with a no-go application at the top end and at the bottom end of a monolithic filler. Total end clearance for fillers in acetylene cylinders shall not exceed the total end-clearance for filler lengths as follows:

Filler length	Total end-clearance
40 inches and over	0.250 inch limit
35 to 40 inches	0.240 inch
30 to 35 inches	0.210 inch
25 to 30 inches	0.180 inch
20 to 25 inches	0.150 inch
15 to 20 inches	0.120 inch
10 to 15 inches	0.090 inch

(e) Twenty year requalification period marking. The code of Federal Regulations does not require retesting of acetylene cylinders fabricated in accordance with specification 8 or 8A1. The CFR Title 49 does not provide for a system of marking acetylene cylinders upon requalification. To identify requalification of Government-owned acetylene cylinders, the new test date, month, and year shall be prefixed by letters (CX6-75). The new test date shall follow the original, or the latest test date, or on a line right below the original test date. Markings shall be permanent and at least 3/8 inch high.

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(f) Requalification records. Records of examination shall be made by competent persons and the results shall be recorded on a prepared data sheet. The completed copies shall be kept as a permanent record. In line with Para. 173.34 (e) (10) of the DOT Regulations requalification results shall be recorded and preserved for the life of the cylinder.

5.3.2. General cylinder maintenance. These cylinders require valve maintenance, repair or rebuild, cleaning, or external maintenance as scheduled. Valve service life is extended by a system to preserve the identity of the valve and its mated cylinder. Valves requiring replacement shall be rejected. Repairable valves or acceptable valves shall be forwarded for valve maintenance and revalving as applicable.

5.3.2.1 Droplight testing. Any time that a valve is removed from a cylinder for any reason, the cylinder shall be given an internal droplight examination in accordance with the following procedure: A light source of sufficient intensity to clearly illuminate the interior walls should be provided. (NOTE: For safety, this light should be low (3-12) voltage with an isolation transformer (no common ground) and the bulb should be protected with some form of a safety shield. If the bulb should break, it could ignite flammable liquids or vapors in the cylinder, resulting in possible damage to the eyes and face.) Before introducing the light, purge the cylinder thoroughly of all residual vapors with dry nitrogen or dry, oil-free air. Then invert it to remove all loose rust and scale and liquid contaminants. Drop the light into the cylinder slowly, positioning the light and the cylinder so that the entire inside surface of the cylinder, except for the blind area just below the neck, can be examined. Tilt the cylinder several degrees from vertical to get the best view of the cylinder wall. Stop the movement of the light as required to permit prolonged inspection of suspect areas. Hold the light so that it first shines directly on a suspect area and then so that any irregularities will produce shadows to improve the examiner's perception of the suspected area. Continue the examination while the light is being withdrawn from the bottom of the cylinder as some defects show up best at this time. The unavoidable blind area just below the cylinder neck cannot be inspected except with sophisticated inspection devices. The wall thickness in this area is heavier than the rest of the cylinder and, because of its location, seldom corrodes as fast as the other interior portions of the cylinder. Contamination in this area can be inferred by an examination of the cylinder neck threads near the bottom of the neck opening and of the visible portions of the upper areas of the cylinder. If the examination discloses substantial internal deposits which make it impossible to inspect the cylinder wall itself, these deposits shall be removed in accordance with mechanical restoration.

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The cylinder shall be reinspected after the deposits are removed. The interpretation of the visual internal inspection must be left to experience. (Surface irregularities may appear greater in height or depth than they really are because of the shadows they cast.) Harmless mill scale and metal discoloration can be misinterpreted as heavy contamination. When in doubt, however, the safe and desirable procedure is to clean by a procedure appropriate to the nature of the apparent impurity. When significant corrosion or possible flaws are suspected, the cylinder shall be further inspected in accordance with the requirements of CGA Pamphlet C-5. A desirable inspection device which can be of great assistance in inspecting questionable cylinders is a borescope. This optical device, which is similar to a periscope, can, by a system of lenses, mirrors, and high intensity light, effectively place the eye inside the cylinder and even magnify the surface under inspection.

5.3.2.2 Cylinder structural maintenance. Cylinder structural dificiencies shall be grouped as follows: Neck, flange and threads, collar and footring, sidewalls, shoulder and bottom heads.

5.3.2.2.1 Government cylinders DOT 3A and 3AA. Cylinders greater than 625 cubic inches in water capacity are supplied with a neck flange in accordance with MIL-C-17376/3. The flange is installed by press fit or by peening into place. Heat cannot be applied to the cylinder, either in removal of the flange or in replacement, as the temper of the steel in the 3A or 3AA cylinder may be changed. Flanges shall be peened tight when found to be loose. Flanges, stretched by abuse shall be replaced in accordance with MIL-C-17376/3. Any permanent markings on a replaced flange shall be permanently marked in the steel of the shoulder of the same cylinder. DOT 3A and 3AA specification cylinders with service pressures over 500 psi are seamless in construction and welding or heating the cylinder is prohibited, but 3A and 3AA specification cylinders with service pressures up to 500 psi are often equipped with welded footrings to protect the bottom areas and to provide a flat surface for upright stability. Repair of 3A or 3AA cylinders shall be restricted to similar cylinder fabricators.

5.3.2.2.2 Government cylinders DOT series 4 and series 8. Cylinders requiring maintenance shall be grouped into those requiring "repair" maintenance and those requiring "rebuild" maintenance. These services shall be performed only by properly certified shops which shall function in accordance with the procedures and limits specified in the Code of Federal Regulations, Title 49, and as specified herein. Repairing or

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rebuilding of welded DOT 4-series or DOT 8-series cylinders shall be in accordance with Code of Federal Regulations Para. 173.34, (i).

5.3.2.2.3 Heat treatment of cylinders. Whenever reheat treatment of a cylinder is proposed, it shall be in accordance with the CFR specifc-cation covering the manufacture of the cylinder in question. Data from the original manufacturing reports for the cylinder shall be available. 3A and 3AA specifications require quenching, annealing, and tempering of the drawn cylinder. The temper of the steel is relative to the strength of the high-pressure cylinder and any change by heat will render the vessel unfit for high pressure service. DOT 4-series and 8-series specifications require heat treatment and annealing of the major components to relieve the stresses of drawing the shells and shaping the sidewalls. These steels are selected for welding properties and therefore repair and rebuild can be provided by certified facilities to restore the life of a damaged cylinder, as applicable.

5.3.2.3 Internal cylinder surface cleaning. Cylinders that require cleaning of the internal surface of contamination, rust, and corrosion or removal of a degraded lining material shall be processed as applicable to restore the cylinder for use to contain the gas specified in the contract or work order.

5.3.2.3.1 Aqueous solution detergent washing. Cylinders can be cleaned by use of aqueous detergent solutions to remove most water and oil based contaminants. All detergent residue must be removed by rinsing and the cylinder must be dried to a dew-point less than 40° F (see 5.3.2.4). Detergent solutions are frequently used to remove organic materials from cylinder interiors. Most effective cleaners are alkaline based solutions of potassium or sodium hydroxide about 8° baume concentration. Solutions are used hot and can cause severe irritation on skin contact or extensive damage if contact is made with the eyes or mucous membranes. Protective clothing shall be worn to protect personnel from the caustic activity of these solutions. Alkaline or detergent solutions do not dissolve oil, grease, or other organic contaminants, but they function by emulsifying them. The cleaning agents attack films of oil or grease, and break them into globules or particles. Each particle of unsoluble liquid or solid material is surrounded by a film of closely adhering detergent, and allows it to float free in the liquid. Heat and agitation enhance cleaning action and thorough rinsing will wash the free particles away with the waste water. Clean hot water must be used

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to prepare an effective cleaning solution. Exceptionally hard water will form insoluble precipitates with the mineral salts in the water and when used will require filtration to prevent clogging of sprayer heads and nozzles. Strength of solution should be no greater than required for effective cleaning.

Procedures:

(1) Cleaning the outside of a cylinder: If inspection shows that oil or grease is confined to the exterior surface of a cylinder, below the neck ring skirt, and none is on the neck ring or valve, remove all external oil by washing with the alkali solution. A stiff brush or rag may be used on the parts difficult to clean. After all contamination is removed, rinse the cylinder thoroughly with clean, running warm water, and return it to service.

(2) Cleaning the inside of a cylinder: Never use the same alkali solution or container for internal washing that has previously been used for external washing. Prepare a fresh batch and proceed as follows:

(a) Fill the cylinder to a little over half its capacity with a solution of hot alkali, and plug the end of the clyinder with a flanged plug and a gasket.

(b) Lay the cylinder on the floor and roll it back and forth for about 15 minutes. If a cylinder roller is available, adjust it so the cylinder is horizontal and allow the cylinder to rotate for 15 minutes.

(c) Immediately upon completion of the rolling, stand the cylinder up, remove the plug, and completely fill the cylinder with clean tap water. Be sure the cylinder is full, as the interior walls must be kept wet until the cylinder is rinsed.

(d) When ready to rinse, empty out the solution. While the cylinder is on its side or slightly inclined with the neck down, rinse the inside with fresh, clean running tap water, making sure that the rinse water reaches all interior surfaces. Continue rinsing until all traces of the cleaning solution are removed. This will require a rinsing period of at least 10 minutes.

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Alternate procedures: There are several alternates to this procedure as listed below. Contractor's proven systems for equivalent cleaning will also be acceptable.

(1) In one modification, a steam lance is inserted to the bottom of the cylinder which has been filled with a solution. Clean, oil- ree steam is injected into the solution through the lance to keep it boiling from 15 to 30 minutes. During the boiling process, enough excess boiling water or steam is injected through the lance so that the solution overflows the cylinder carrying away the contaminants which have floated to the surface. When cleaning is completed, rinse the cylinder as specified above.
(2) In another procedure, the cylinder is positioned with its valve opening down. A mixture of high pressure steam and a cleaning solution such as the one given in the primary procedure is injected into the cylinder through a steam lance. The lance should be moved up and down and sideways so that the cleaning fluid will contact the entire inside surface of the cylinder. Rotating the cylinder is helpful.
(3) Some contaminants can be removed with steam alone without the cleaning compound.

5.3.2.3.2 Organic solvent washing. Organic solvent washing involves pouring a liquid organic solvent into the cylinder and rotating it so that all surfaces are contacted by the solvent. Experience has indicated more than 90 percent of all cylinders which are oil or hydrocarbon contaminated can be cleaned adequately with organic solvents to render the cylinder suitable for use in oxygen or any other service. Cleaning depends upon the ability of the solvent to dissolve organic materials in a short period of time, the ability of the solvent to leave only a small amount of nonvolatile residue on the walls of a cylinder and upon the solvent not reacting chemically with the cylinder material. Many commercial solvents meet these requirements and do a good job of cleaning. Among them are: trichloroethylene, trichlorotrifluoroethylene, perchloroethylene, and trichloroethane 1, 1, 1. CGA Pamphlet G-4.1 provides considerable information about solvents and their characteristics. Carbon tetrachloride shall not be used for cleaning cylinders due to its extreme toxicity. Almost all solvents are harmful if breathed to excess. Cylinder cleaning with these solvents should be done only in an area with positive ventilation and only by persons wearing adequate equipment to protect the eyes and skin. Care should be taken not to subject any cylinder with water soluble contamination to solvent cleaning, as such

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treatment may change the contamination into insoluble gums. Identification of the contamination in a cylinder can usually be made by examination with a droplight or by filling a cylinder with water and then, after the water has been in the cylinder for 24 hours, examining the surface of the water in the neck opening of the cylinder for the presence of oil or other light hydrocarbons. When both water soluble and water insoluble compounds are found, the cylinder shall first be washed with an alkaline solvent in accordance with 5.3.2.3.1 and then washed with organic solvents in accordance with this procedure. Pour clean solvent into the neck of the cylinder until the cylinder is from 1/10 to 1/4 full. Plug the neck opening with a flanged, gasketed plug, lay the cylinder on its side, and rotate it for approximately 15 minutes. The cylinder can be rotated either with a mechanical rotating machine or by rolling back and forth on the floor. It should be rocked from side to side periodically so as to contact all interior surfaces. Empty the cylinder and observe the discharge solvent. If the solvent is dirty, repeat the cleaning procedure using fresh solvent. Do not use the original solvent as it could redeposit contaminants. When a solvent reclaiming procedure is available, some solvents may be reclaimed by boiling and condensing the vapors. Otherwise, the solvent shall be discarded. After cleaning, the cylinder shall be dried and purged to remove all residual solvent.

5.3.2.3.3 Vapor degreasing of cylinders. Solvent cleaning by vapor degreasing uses a tank with immersed heaters to vaporize the solvent. The solvent vapor is discharged through an injection tube over which a cylinder is placed. The hot vapors condense on the internal walls of the cylinder being cleaned, dissolve the oil contamination, and return to the tank by gravity. The solvent thus becomes contaminated with oil and the boiling temperature of the mixture of solvent and oil increases slightly. Even though the solvent becomes contaminated, the vapor driven off by heating is clean solvent. The cylinder is thus cleaned at all times with clean solvent.

5.3.2.3.3.1 Procedure of vapor degreasing.

(1) The cylinder should be rinsed with water internally and externally and then thoroughly dried.
(2) Invert cylinder, with an appropriate hanger, and lower it over the injection tube of the vapor degreaser cleaner. The injection tube must almost reach the base of the cylinder. Various sizes of tubes should be available for use with each unit.

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(3) The cylinder should be left on the cleaner for 15 to 45 minutes after vapor starts to issue from the neck of the cylinder. The time required depends upon the type and quantity of the contamination.
(4) Remove the cylinder from the vapor degreaser and immediately purge it with at least 100 cubic feet of oil-free compressed air or nitrogen. Exhaust the cylinder to the outside of the building.
(5) Immediately dry the cylinder thoroughly to avoid the possibility of corrosion. 1,1,1 trichloroethane (inhibited) has worked satisfactorily with vapor degreasing units. Avoid hazardous concentrations of the degreasing vapor in the area.

5.3.2.3.4 Mechanical cylinder cleaning. When the internal surfaces of a cylinder have become oxidized or corroded to the extent that an internal inspection cannot be made, the oxidized material shall be removed by iron based abrasives, by shot blast, or by use of a spinning mandrel and a steel chain.

5.3.2.3.4.1 Shot blast. A shot blast system utilizes high-pressure air to drive particles of iron or steel of a uniform size against the internal surface of the cylinder. The action will cut coatings, rust, scale, or corrosive products free from the reduced steel of the cylinder. A free exhausting of air and debris through the narrow neck of a cylinder is a controlling factor in a shot blasting system. Care shall also be exercised not to cut away reduced steel, thereby excessively reducing the wall thickness. Resulting surfaces are of high quality and after removal of fine particles, are generally acceptable for charging with gas commodity without danger of contamination.

5.3.2.3.4.2 Rolling iron abrasives. For cylinders with light scale of rust or pitting and corrosive build-up, a cleaning process can be achieved by placing a quantity of iron based abrasives in the cylinder and rotating it on a mechanical rolling table. Such a system will abrade lightly and produces an excellent surface in which pit depths can be readily inspected. Cylinders coated heavily with scale and corrosive products respond very slowly to the rolling system as the oxidation products quickly cushion the cutting action of the abrasives and the system loses efficiency.

5.3.2.3.4.3 Mandrel and chain. A mandrel and chain system utilizes a spinning shaft long enough to reach the bottom of a cylinder with a chain attached at the very end and at intervals along its useful length. The chain must be longer than the radius of the cylinder. As wear on the chain progresses links at the ends must be replaced. The shaft shall be turned in both directions to effect an acceptable metal surface; however, the cylinder bottom cannot be cleaned by this system,

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but the internal shoulder area responds very well as the spinning chain approaches the neck of the cylinder. The oxidation and corrosive products are wiped into the pits and dents of a cylinder with the spinning chain. Aqueous solution cleaning is often needed to remove loosened particles and pitting depths are very hard to judge at internal inspection after a chain and mandrel process.

5.3.2.3.5 Heat treatment cleaning. There are certain types of contaminants which cannot be removed by either organic solvent cleaning or inorganic solution cleaning. The only practical method of removing these contaminants is to burn them out. Since this procedure involves heating the cylinder very close to or to the temperature at which its physical properties are modified, the procedure should be carried out by an agency completely familiar with the properties of the cylinder and in possession of the original manufacturing report for the cylinder. The cylinder is heated to a temperature, depending upon the original heat-treatment of the cylinder, and held at this temperature while air is injected into it through a lance inserted nearly to the cylinder bottom. The stream of air is continued until all evidence of combustion such as flame, smoke, etc., has stopped.

Procedures: Temperatures are precise (*see following guidelines*).

(1) Quenched and tempered cylinders - minimum temperature - 1150° F; maximum-tempering temperature as shown in manufacturing report.
(2) Normalized cylinders - temperature as shown in manufacturing report.
(3) If possible, the agency performing this type of cleaning should be the cylinder manufacturer.
(4) After the heating, all of the applicable portions of DOT regulations, including retest, shall be performed.

5.3.2.4 Internal cylinder drying. Each cylinder that has accumulated water or has had water introduced for maintenance purposes shall be inverted and drained free of water, and dried until the dew point of effluent gas is less than 40° F, tested in accordance with ASTM D 2029 or by equivalent method. When preservation of the internal surfaces is required for periods of storage, for high purity conditions, or for ABO cylinders, heat shall be applied to the cylinder or hot gas shall be passed through the cylinder until 180° F surface temperature is reached. The cylinder shall be immediately valved closed or sealed with a plug and gasket. Medical gas cylinders shall be dried with gas of intended use or with dry air.

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5.3.2.4.1 Ambient air drying. This procedure is widely used in cylinder processing to achieve a dew point of 40° F on the effluent side. Drying characteristics will vary widely with relative humidity and temperature. Controlled systems must be proven or constantly monitored by dew point testing or by equivalent analysis.

5.3.2.4.2 Hot nitrogen gas drying. Heated nitrogen is forced through a lance which is inserted to within 1 inch of the bottom of the cylinder. Hot nitrogen is passed through the cylinder until the external cylinder surface at the open end reaches 180° F. The cylinder must be valved closed or plugged at this elevated temperature to assure its dry interior condition.

5.3.2.4.3 Vacuum and heat drying. The cylinder is dried by a vacuum drawn on a cylinder immersed in 180° F water. A vacuum of not less than 3 inches of mercury absolute pressure must be maintained for 30 minutes. Without access to ambient air, the cylinder should be pressurized to not less than 5 psi with nitrogen gas or the gas of intended use and valved closed.

5.3.2.5 Valves and safety devices. Each cylinder valve requiring maintenance shall be repaired as applicable. Valves not in accordance with MIL-V-2 and on current QPL may remain in service as long as they are functional, clean, and free of damage. Safety devices shall be in accordance with CGA S-1 or replaced as required. All materials used in fabrication as applied to Government medical valves shall pass tests specified in MSFC-SPEC-101A(NASA).

5.3.2.5.1 Valve maintenance. Valves shall be cleaned free of insects, webs, dirt, paint, corrosion, oil, or grease. Valves may be effectively cleaned using trichlorethane (MIL-T-81533) or a commercial oxygen equipment cleaning solvent safe at ambient temperatures.

5.3.2.5.1.1 Hand wheels, packing glands, bonnet nuts, and valve seats. The use of salvaged hand wheels is acceptable whenever a match in drive can be made. Packing glands must be tightened to assure a gas tight seal on the stem. Bonnet nuts must be locked tight. The valve seat must seal gas tight when hand closed, and the stem must backseal when in the full open position. Damaged stems or plugs and integral seats shall be replaced with a manufacturer's kit.

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5.3.2.5.1.2 Valve inlet and outlet connections. Valves with less than one thread previously mated in cylinder installation shall be rejected and replaced. Valve outlets must have smooth seats which are free of nicks or dents on the sealing surfaces. Threads will be free running in the mated connections. Outlets shall be in accordance with the Compressed Gas Association's ANSI B-57.1 and the contract or work order.

5.3.2.5.1.3 Valve outlet, caps, and plugs. Outlet caps or plugs shall be provided for toxic gas service in accordance with MIL-V-2 and the applicable specification sheet. When specified in the contract or work order for nontoxic service, caps or plugs shall be provided in accordance with MIL-V-2 and the applicable specification sheet.

5.3.2.5.2 Safety devices. The safety device for each valve shall be in accordance with MIL-V-2 and for the service specified in the item description. Mismatched, leaking, or extruded safety devices shall be replaced as complete units (cap, disk, and washer). A faulty safety device which is integral to the valve body is cause for replacement of the valve. The combination frangible disk, burst pressure 2700-3000 psi, backed with fusible metal (Style 4-165° F or Style 5-212° F) as applicable, is an authorized safety device for cylinders with marked service pressures 1800 through 2400 psi. This safety device meets all requirements of the Department of Transportation, and the recommendations of the Compressed Gas Association for compressed high-pressure gas applications when used in accordance with MIL-V-2. The combination safety device shall not be used for cryogenic liquid sample cylinders or with any cylinder that has been tested and stamped with a (+) mark after the last hydrostatic test date. The (+) mark indicates that the cylinder may be filled to a pressure 10 percent above the marked service pressure and therefore the use of a frangible disk safety device is mandatory regardless whether the cylinder is pressurized to the higher level or only to the marked service pressure. A Style 1 frangible disk for the specific service pressure marked on the cylinder, when applicable, is the preferred safety device.

5.3.2.5.3 Valve installation. All valves shall be installed in cylinders using an antisieze thread compound or thread tape. All oxygen valves and high pressure valve services shall be installed with one to three turns of polytetra/fluoroethylene tape conforming to MIL-T-27730. One thread should remain exposed at the lead end of the inlet threads when applying tape or thread compound to assure against

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cylinder contamination. The use of fluorocarbon lubricants stable in oxygen atmospheres may be used to increase the effectiveness of the polytetra/fluoroethylene tape. Hydrocarbon lubricants are prohibited in compressed gas service. All valves should be installed and torqued until a maximum of five and not less than one full thread shows above the cylinder. New valves should have as near five threads showing as is possible to effect a tight seal. When a valve is reinstalled in its mated cylinder, a reliable seal can be achieved by torquing the valve one-half to one full thread into the cylinder beyond its previous installation. Used valves should seal displaying one to two threads less than with any previous installation. If a gas-tight seal cannot be achieved through a reasonable application of the above guidelines, the cylinder shall be rejected and marked condemned for enlarged neck threads. Except for chlorine service, oversized valve inlet threads are not approved in the Government system.

5.3.2.5.4 Valve replacement and disposal. Improper or rejected valves than cannot be reconditioned shall be condemned and replaced with valves in accordance with MIL-V-2. Condemned valves shall be returned to the Government for disposal, as condition condemned property. A simple control may be achieved by tying the unrepairable valve to the installed new valve to be returned with the service cylinder.

5.3.2.5.5 Cylinder plugs in lieu of valve. When specified by the item description tapered plugs or plugs with flange and gasket shall be installed in the cylinder neck opening. Plugs shall have National Gas Threads provided with wrench flats for easy removal. The plug must effect an airtight seal to preserve the internal surfaces of the cylinder from oxidation and corrosion in storage.

5.3.3 General maintenance of acetylene cylinders. Acetylene cylinders accepted at inspection with valid 20 year requalification dates shall be scheduled for maintenance as follows:

(a) The acetone shall be adjusted to reflect the marked tare weight of the cylinder (see 5.3.3.1).
(b) Safety relief devices shall be S-3 with a fuse metal melting point of 212° F (see 5.2.3, 5.2.4 and 5.3.2.5.3).
(c) Valves shall be maintained in accordance with 5.3.2.5.
(d) The external cylinder surfaces shall be maintained in accordance with 5.3.6.
(e) The valve protection cap shall be maintained in accordance with 5.3.6.1.

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5.3.3.1 Acetone adjustment. Excessive weight is indicative of water absorption by the acetone in the filler. Poor acetylene absorption is another indication of water vapor trapped in the porous filler. Either condition requires bleeding of the acetylene gas, heat evaporation of the acetone, baking dry the porous filler, and recharging with dry acetone to the tare weight of the cylinder. A low tare weight indicates excessive corrosion and wasting of the steel cylinder, or loss of acetone by fast withdrawal of the acetylene by the user. Each cylinder shall be weighed and checked against its marked tare weight.

(a) Cylinders under weight will require adjustment of the acetone in quantities up to 20 percent of the authorized weight of the acetone charge. Cylinders with greater deficiencies shall be rejected and returned to the Government for disposition.
(b) Cylinder over weight may be handled by the contractor's standard practice for removing excess acetone or small accumulations of moisture. Cylinders with excess moisture, heavy enough to inhibit the absorption of acetylene shall be rejected and returned to the Government for disposition.
(c) When specified in the work order or contract, cylinders rejected for deficiency and low weight or for excessive moisture and heavy weight shall be corrected by evaporation of acetone, baking dry and recharging with acetone to proper tare weight.

5.3.4 Chlorine cylinder maintenance. Each chlorine cylinder shall have its valve removed, the residual chlorine gas purged with atmospheric air, and shall be internally inspected by droplight test. Cylinders rejected for internal corrosion must be subjected to a cleaning process to remove any corrosion residue for a determination of internal cylinder damage. Excessive eroding is an indication for hydrostatic testing regardless of the periodic test status of the cylinder before returning to chlorine gas service. The cylinder rejected for eroded neck threads must be retapped with the applicable NGO tapered threads to a depth of up to 4 threads according to need for full roots and crests in the female thread forms. Such a cylinder shall be refitted with a valve with inlet threads machined from one to four threads oversized as applicable and in accordance with the chlorine valve specification sheet MIL-V-2/20. Chlorine cylinders are the only cylinders that are authorized to be fitted with valves with oversized inlet threads by MIL-V-2. Neither chlorine liquid nor gas will attack and corrode iron or steel unless a slight amount of water is trapped within the cylinders. When moisture is present, the water will hydrolyze with the chlorine to produce small amounts of hypochlorous and hydrochloric acid. The

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dilute acid can attack any spot on the cylinder, but tends to show affinity for sharp edges or points. As a result, the restored chlorine cylinder must be thoroughly dried before it is returned to chlorine service after any maintenance or hydrostatic test procedure.

5.3.5 Special handling. When specified in the contract or the item description, each cylinder shall be prepared by special handling. Each cylinder shall have a valid periodic test date or will be scheduled for test or examination as applicable. Each cylinder with a valid test must have its valve removed and must be subjected to a droplight examination to determine the condition of its internal surface. The cleaning of the cylinder internally shall be in accordance with the following procedures as applicable, unless otherwise specified in the contract or work order:

(a) When the commodity is a permanent gas, the cylinder wall shall be free of oil and grease or any contamination that will volatilize in the compressed gas, as the impurity will be carried along with the gas as it is withdrawn. Generally, any odor in a cylinder is indicative of such contamination. Cleaning will require detergent application followed by hydrocarbon solvent application in very stubborn cases. Oil and grease will generally respond to hot detergent cleaning. Generally, oxide corrosion of the steel sidewall is not a problem in contaminating a permanent gas, unless the corrosion is progressive enough to trigger failure by hammer test. Rust particulate matter will not contaminate the effluent gas from a permanent gas cylinder, however, accumulations greater than 1.5 grams identified by droplight or by inverting and dumping, shall dictate removal by mechanical cleaning, aqueous cleaning, high-pressure air or steam, as applicable.

(b) When the commodity is a liquified gas to be withdrawn as a liquid or a gas through a diptube, the sidewall shall be free of oil and grease and loose, fine particle corrosion. This corrosion residue may be removed by mechanical methods or by forced flushing. Tight scale, shallow pitting, and sidewall rust stain are generally acceptable when diptube withdrawal is utilized.

(c) When the commodity is a liquified gas to be withdrawn as a liquid of high purity by inversion of the cylinder, the sidewalls, bottom, and shoulders shall be free of all contamination, rust, and corrosion to the reduced metal level. The cleaning procedure of choice is iron shot blast. Other mechanical or chemical methods may be used if residues from processing can be removed in accordance with ASTM D 2200, Standard B-Sa-1.

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(d) Special handling cylinders shall be immediately dried in accordance with 5.3.2.4.2 or 5.3.2.4.3 so the corrosion level will be held to be static until the cylinder is charged. Cylinders prepared in special handling must be charged immediately or they must be preserved with dry inert gas and closed by revalving or by plug and gasket.

5.3.6 External cylinder surface maintenance. The cylinder requiring external surface maintenance shall have the valve masked against stripping solutions and paint spray. The valve protection cap will be turned hand tight onto the cylinder flange. The cylinder must be cleared of decals and stickers, all old paint stripped, and the rust removed to the reduced metal. The cylinder shall be refinished in accordance with MIL-T-704, Type C, and as specified herein. The materials supplied to paint Government cylinders shall be in accordance with or equal to TT-E-489. Lacquer materials acceptable for painting Government cylinders shall be in accordance with TT-L-32. Cylinders and valve protection caps shall be color coded and stenciled in accordance with MIL-STD-101. Paint shall be uniform in colors conforming to FED. STD. No. 595.

5.3.6.1 Cylinder valve protection caps. Replace the cap on the cylinder flange. If the threads are not free running, clean both the cap and flange threads with a wire brush to remove rust or chase the threads with tap or dye as applicable. Cap threads that cannot be cleaned to run free shall be cause for rejection and replacement with a new cap in accordance with MIL-C-17376/1. Cylinders under 625 cubic inches in water capacity are not required to have flanges and valve protection caps unless the cylinder is provided with a threaded flange.

5.3.6.2 Paint, decal, and rust removal. Before painting a Government cylinder, the old paint, any decals, and oxidation shall be removed to the reduced metal. Decals and stickers must be removed before stripping either by chemical or by mechanical systems. Chemical stripping systems using caustic or phosphate solutions perform well in removing paint, but do not attack the oxidized surfaces of denuded metal. This oxidation must be removed by chemical reducing agents, mechanical abrasives, or a combination of both. Shot blasting is an effective means for removing hard paint without severe erosion of the metal cylinder wall in controlled processes. Removal of rust is achieved in a mechanical process of shot blasting and no need exists for rinsing residue or for drying as is the case with chemical processes.

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5.3.6.2.1 Release of compressed gas in 150° F stripping solution. DOT service pressure regulations are based on expansion limitations at 130° F maximum. If cylinders containing compressed gas or liquified gas residuals are subjected to temperatures in excess of 130° F during stripping or drying, safety device limits may be exceeded and contained gas will be released into the paint stripping area.

5.3.6.2.2 Caustic stripping. Paint can be stripped from cylinders in caustic solutions of varying concentrations depending on the working temperature and mechanical agitation.

(a) Cold caustic solutions 25 percent. Ambient temperatures 60° to 80° F will strip paint from submerged cylinders in 4 hours time. Such a slow process does not lend itself to production principles and saturated flanges will drain for extended periods of time over newly painted surfaces.
(b) Hot caustic solutions 25 percent. Solutions heated to 150° F, plus or minus 20° F, will strip old paint from a submerged cylinder in 10 to 12 minutes. Agitation of the solution will increase the general effectiveness of the stripping procedure more than it will decrease the stripping time. A long narrow tank of depth equal to cylinder height will lend itself to continuous monorail application.
(c) Hot caustic solutions 15 percent pressure sprayed. Solutions heated to 150° F, plus or minus 20° F, circulated through a coarse filter, screen, or a settling process and directed uniformly in pressure spray against the cylinder wall, will strip old paint to the base metal in 10 to 12 minutes. Cylinders hanging from a monorail which will rotate as they pass through an enclosed spray cabinet for the allotted time would constitute an efficient production system.

5.3.6.2.3 Water rinsing of caustic solutions. Cold water rinsing is possible but the caustic solutions will require volumes of fresh water for flooding and must then be dried by forced air to control surface oxidation. When the caustic solution is rinsed away with hot water with a temperature of 150° F, plus or minus 20° F, it will leave a residual heat in the cylinder that will allow the cylinder surface to evaporate to dryness in the ambient air. Ambient drying can be controlled by circulating room air about the cylinders and exhausting a portion to control the relative humidity.

5.3.6.2.4 Rust removal. A fast dry of the newly stripped cylinder will control surface oxidation. A thoroughly dry surface is best for the mechanical removal of any rust that may be present on the surface of the recently stripped cylinder.

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5.3.6.3 Metal surface pretreatment. The reduced metal surface shall be treated and passivated if the best adhesion and refinishing is to be achieved. The surface of a cylinder recently cleared of old paint and rust displaying the reduced metal condition, will oxidize very quickly if it is not immediately protected. MIL-T-704 limits delay in surface preparation of reduced metal to 4 hours. Within this time frame the metal cylinder surface should be sealed with an impervious deoxidizing prime coat, or coated with either Type I, zinc phosphate or Type II, iron phosphate chemical agents conforming to TT-C-490. Surfaces may be prepared by wash primers conforming to MIL-P-15328 or MIL-C-8514.

5.3.6.4 Prime coating. A prime coat shall be applied over treated metal surfaces as soon as possible in normal processing. Only primed cylinders are to be held in storage. After extended storage, the surfaces must be freed of oil, grease, dust, and stains before finishing. The prime coat shall be compatible with the proposed finish coat. The paint must dry hard creating an impervious moisture seal over the base metal with a thickness of 1.0 to 1.5 mils. For continuous operations where there is a minimum of time elapse (less than 1 hour), a deoxidizing primer such as a combination of basic zinc chromate and phenolic vinyl butyral may be used to combine the metal surface preparation and the prime coating in one operation. If such a deoxidizing primer is used, the finish paint shall be compatible with the hard prime base and react with inseparable adhesive properties when curing is completed.

5.3.6.5 Finish coating. The finish coat of exterior paint shall be sprayed over a cured prime paint to a thickness that will assure smooth and even flow that will be free of pits and achieve a sealed glossy surface. Excessive thickness will be regarded as an inferior quality. A heavy buildup of cured paint residue promotes chipping and scratching.

5.3.6.6 Touch-up painting. Touch-up painting may be applied to cylinders displaying localized chipping such as chipping from an anchoring chain or when specified in the contract or the delivery order. Excessive chipping will require stripping and refinishing completely (see 5.2.2.1).

5.4 Cylinder charging. Except for acetylene, butane, propane, anhydrous ammonia, and carbon dioxide, each cylinder shall be evacuated to an absolute pressure of 3 inches of mercury or greater and maintained for a minimum of 2 minutes before charging begins. The cylinder shall be

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charged with the applicable gas equivalent to the marked service pressure or with liquified gas to its authorized weight in accordance with the cylinder design. Any gas bled from cylinders must be disposed of in accordance with current environmental requirements.

5.4.1 Charging cylinders with permanent gas (oxygen, nitrogen, hydrogen, argon, helium, air, and carbon monoxide). These cylinders arrive at the charging station with residual pressure from previous use or are filled with air and dried to a dewpoint of approximately 40° F. Each cylinder shall be evacuated to a minimum absolute pressure of 3 inches of mercury (Hg) and maintained for 2 minutes before filling begins. High purity gases, oxygen, helium, argon, nitrogen and other gases with purity levels above 99.95 percent shall be prepared for charging by double evacuation. Dried cylinders and cylinders with residual gas shall be evacuated to a minimum absolute pressure of 3 inches of mercury, pressurized with the gas of intended use to not less than 10 psi and again evacuated to a minimum absolute pressure of 3 inches of mercury for 2 minutes before actual charging begins. Each cycle of evacuation will reduce any residual gas remaining in a cylinder to approximately 10 percent of its previous level. Each cylinder shall be charged with the applicable gas in accordance with the item description to a pressure level equivalent to the marked service pressure at 70° F. Equivalent pressure/temperature tables will be found in the applicable commodity specification.

5.4.2 Charging cylinders of liquified gases. Liquified gas cylinders will include liquified petroleum gas, fuel gas mixtures, fluorocarbon refrigerants, ammonia, chlorine, and sulfur hexafluoride. The cylinders for these gases are 3-series seamless specification or 4-series welded specification, as applicable for the particular gas and its maximum vapor pressure at 130° F. Each service will provide specific control of the quality of the commodity contained. The cylinders for each service must be handled to preserve the properties of the commodity specification as applicable. The authorized weight and the nominal capacity presented in the item description for a cylinder in a specific liquified gas service shall be equivalent values but shall never exceed the filling density in accordance with the CFR Title 49, Para. 173.304.

5.4.2.1 Charging ammonia cylinders. At a charging station, ammonia cylinders will contain slightly more than one atmosphere of ammonia gas pressure or one atmosphere of dry ambient air when the cylinder is new or requires maintenance. Ammonia may be filled to a density not greater than 54 percent of the cylinder water capacity by weight at 60° F. Cylinders with residual ammonia gas, and cylinders filled with ambient air can be handled together. Check and record the marked tare

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weight. Attach the ammonia cylinder to the ammonia recharging line and allow the pressure head to flow liquified ammonia into the cylinder to the authorized weight of the cylinder. Close the valve and disconnect the recharging line. If the cylinder is filled over the authorized weight, bleed the excess liquified ammonia as gas to the net product weight. Record the quantity of ammonia filled. Charged anhydrous ammonia cylinders which contain one atmosphere of dry ambient air shall be adjusted by the escape of not less than 5 cu. ft. of gas to assure the preferential release of most of the trapped air.

5.4.2.2 Charging chlorine cylinders. At a charging station chlorine cylinders will contain approximately one atmosphere of dry air or nitrogen. Place the chlorine cylinder on a manifold capable of drawing a vacuum and introducing a pressure head of liquid chlorine without exposure to ambient air. The chlorine cylinder shall first be evacuated to 3 inches of Hg. and after gate valves are switched to the liquified chlorine head, the cylinder shall be slowly filled. Chlorine containers are approved for a filling density of 125 percent times the containers' water capacity by weight. Record the tare weight and fill the cylinder to its authorized weight. If the cylinder is filled over the authorized weight, adjust the chlorine for net product weight of the cylinder. Record the quantity of chlorine filled.

5.4.2.3 Charging of fluorocarbon refrigerant cylinders. At the charging station, Government fluorocarbon cylinders will have been subjected to an internal inspection and necessary maintenance followed by drying to a dewpoint not greater than 40° F with ambient air. Each fluorocarbon refrigerant shall be charged to the filling density not greater than specified in the CFR Title 49, Para. 173.304, times the water capacity of the cylinder For its authorized weight. The cylinder shall be weighed to determine its specific tare weight and recorded. Before charging, the cylinder shall be evacuated to 3 inches of mercury and without access of ambient air the cylinder shall be charged to the authorized weight with a specific refrigerant. At a final weighing, the contents of the cylinder shall be adjusted for net product weight for the cylinder as applicable.

5.4.2.4 Charging cylinders with liquified petroleum gas. At a charging station, a liquified petroleum cylinder will be empty and will have the same base weight as its tare weight, or it will contain liquified gas and its base weight will be somewhat heavier than its marked tare weight. Record the base weight of each LPG cylinder to be recharged. Liquified petroleum may be filled to a density not greater than 42 percent of the cylinder water capacity by weight @ 60° F. Connect the

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valve outlet to the LPG charging line, and fill the cylinder. Cylinders filled with air will block filling at some point short of being full, as the pressure of the compressed air reaches the recharging head pressure. To prevent pressure block, the cylinder valve outlet connection must be cracked periodically during recharging to allow the trapped air to escape. Government liquified petroleum cylinders are made to contain the authorized weight as specified in the item description. A cylinder shall be charged to its authorized weight. The base weight recorded for the specific cylinder shall be subtracted from the gross weight and recorded as the net product weight of liquified petroleum required for recharging.

5.4.2.5 Charging cylinders with fuel gas mixture Fuel gas mixtures are supplied to the Government as proprietary products. Government cylinders are provided for filling to nominal weights such as 7.5 lbs for portable applications or 70 lbs for stationary or mobile applications. These gases ar· an inhibited mixture of gases which are readily liquified under pressure, to be handled like liquified petroleum in charging. The fuel gas cylinder shall be weighed to determine its tare weight and recorded. The cylinder is charged to its authorized weight with liquified commodity. The net product weight is determined to be the gross weight less the recorded tare weight.

5.4.2.6 Charging carbon dioxide cylinders. Carbon dioxide cylinders arrive at the charging station with residual pressure from previous filling or contain one atmosphere of gas from drying at 180° F. When a cylinder contains residual carbon dioxide, it shall be bled down to one atmosphere of pressure. Connection shall be made with the carbon dioxide supply manifold and charging shall follow. When a cylinder has been dried at 180° F and closed, a negative pressure will be developed on cooling. Connect the valve outlet to the carbon dioxide supply manifold with a gas tight seal before the cylinder valve is opened to prevent the contamination of the cylinder with atmospheric moisture. Carbon dioxide should be purchased by weight. The net product weight of carbon dioxide supplied in each cylinder is the difference between the filled weight and the unfilled weight of the cylinder. Carbon dioxide cylinders shall never be charged above 68 percent filling density.

5.4.2.7 Sulfur hexafluoride. At the charging station sulfur hexafluoride cylinders will be exhausted, devalved, purged with air, internally inspected, and cleaned to the base metal in accordance with 5.3.5, (c) and (d). Each cylinder may be charged to a filling density not greater than 110 percent times the water capacity of the cylinder. Each cylinder shall be weighed and recorded for tare weight. The cylinder shall be evacuated

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to an absolute pressure of 3 inches of mercury and maintained for a minimum of 2 minutes before filling begins. The cylinder shall be charged with sulfur hexafluoride to its authorized weight. The net product weight is determined to be the gross weight less the recorded tare weight.

5.4.3 Charging cylinders with acetylene. An acetylene cylinder at charging will ordinarily have a residual amount of acetylene dissolved in its acetone carrier and will have a heavier base weight than its marked tare weight, or cylinders devalved for inspection or acetone adjustment will have a base weight corresponding to the tare weight. Base weights shall be recorded and the cylinder shall be connected to the acetylene manifold. A given source of acetylene in cubic feet capacity per hour must be mated with a bank of cylinders capable of absorbing all the acetylene generated. Differential conditions can be varied at higher pressure (400 psi max.) or at lower temperature (cooling closets) until a cylinder settled pressure of 250 psi at 70° F or equivalent is achieved. Weigh the charged cylinder. With the base weight, calculate the quantity of the dissolved gas by weight and its equivalent cubic footage using the conversion factor of 14.7 cubic feet of acetylene per pound of gas weight. Record the number of cubic feet required to charge the cylinder. The dissolved weight of acetylene shall never exceed a cylinder's capacity in cubic feet divided by the conversion factor (14.7).

5.4.4 Leakage test. Each cylinder that is charged with compressed gas in accordance with the contract or work order shall be inspected and tested for leakage. Testing shall be carried out by immersion in water or by the use of soap solution or an equivalent leak detection agent, except ABO cylinders (see 5.4.4.1). Cylinders with valves leaking at the seats or stems shall be tightened to establish leak free seals. Never loosen the bonnet nut or the packing nut of a charged cylinder valve. Cylinders with leaking valves or leaking valve inlet threads shall be relieved of internal pressure, inspected and scheduled for applicable maintenance. Cylinders with leaking inlet neck threads which are oversized (except for chlorine cylinders) shall be marked "Condemned" and returned to the Government for disposal.

5.4.4.1 Leak testing for ABO cylinders. Leak testing of charged ABO cylinders shall use a tube or outlet connected pig-tail with the extremity under a liquid, to test for valve seat leakage without valve outlet contamination. ABO cylinder valve leak testing shall use leak detection compounds in accordance with MIL-L-25567.

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5.4.5 Special tag for filled cylinders procured by the military medical services. A tag constructed in accordance with UU-T-81, Type B, Class 2, Size 5, Grade SU, shall be attached to each filled cylinder. Marking shall include the name of the specified gas, serial number of the cylinder, and necessary precautionary markings. The statement "CAUTION: Federal law prohibits dispensing without prescription" shall appear on the tag, if it does not appear on the cylinder. Tags shall be furnished with metal eyelet and stringing wire. Wire shall be tinned, annealed, or galvanized. Tag colors shall be as follows:

Background - Same color as cylinders
Print - Black

or

Background - White
Print - Same color as cylinders

In addition, the bottom of the tag shall be designed with a three-part legend, marked on both sides of the tag as follows:

"EMPTY"

"IN USE"

"FULL"

A perforation shall be placed between the words "FULL" and "IN USE" and between the words "IN USE" and "EMPTY" in order that these legends may be removed by tearing, when they are no longer applicable.

The Government will furnish DD Form 1191 Warning Tag for Medical Oxygen Equipment for placement on oxygen cylinders.

Note: Filled cylinders shall be packed and marked as specified in the applicable specifications for the cylinder, except that any reference that cylinders are empty shall, of course, not apply.

In addition, each filled Ethylene Oxide-Dichlorodifluoromethane Mixture cylinder shall be marked with the legend:

"STORE IN A COOL PLACE (50° F - 80° F)"

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